

STEPCLIMBER · BUILD PLAN

StepClimber prototype build plan

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.3	2026-10-02	Amish Chadha	Making sketch of the cluster shaft (SCM-DWG-106) redrawn at revision P2 with the 4140 material; general arrangement at revision P5; figures from SCM-CAL-001 v0.5
0.2	2026-10-02	Amish Chadha	Decisions of 2026-10-02 carried in: cluster shaft in 4140 (section 3.6), drive check at 16 steps/min, tilt stop at 3 degrees (SCM-DEC-001, items 1, 3 and 4)
0.1	2026-10-01	Amish Chadha	First build plan, with pictures by component and step; design made constructable (SCM-DDR-003)

StepClimber prototype build plan

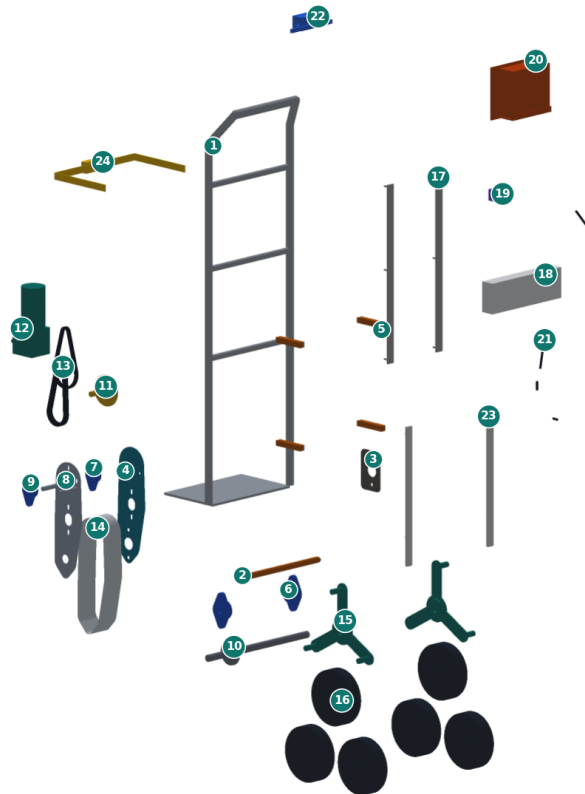
Plan, not yet built. How to build the first proof-of-concept prototype, component by component. Building and testing to it is TRL 4 work. Decisions still to be made are kept in the design decisions register ([docs/06-design-decisions.md](#)), not here.

1. What you are building

StepClimber prototype: every component, pulled apart

Numbered in build order. Upright, seen from the drive side and the back (the stair side)

- 1 ■ Hand truck frame (bought)
- 2 ■ Replacement lowest cross bar
- 3 ■ Axle plate, plain side
- 4 ■ Chain case outer plate
- 5 ■ Skid standoffs (4)
- 6 ■ Main shaft bearings (2)
- 7 ■ Outer countershaft bearing
- 8 ■ Chain case inner plate and spacers
- 9 ■ Inner countershaft bearing
- 10 ■ Cluster shaft and 20-tooth sprocket
- 11 ■ Countershaft and its two sprockets
- 12 ■ Worm gearmotor and 10-tooth sprocket
- 13 ■ Chains (2)
- 14 ■ Chain case band
- 15 ■ Spiders with weld-on hubs and stub axles (2)
- 16 ■ Wheels (6) and their fixings
- 17 ■ Component uprights (2)
- 18 ■ Electronics box with driver and controller
- 19 ■ Fuse box and key switch
- 20 ■ Pack cradle and pack
- 21 ■ Harness
- 22 ■ Handle controls
- 23 ■ Nosing guard skids (2)
- 24 ■ Load strap



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Figure 1. Every component pulled apart and numbered in build order, seen from the drive side and the back.

The prototype is one StepClimber: a bought steel hand truck whose wheels are replaced by two powered tri-star wheel clusters on one shaft. A worm gearmotor turns the shaft through two chain stages in a closed chain case on the right-hand rail (the drive side), and an electronics box, a battery pack and a fuse box hang on two uprights behind the frame. Figure 1 shows the 24 components in the order you make or fit them. Nine are made in a small workshop: the replacement lowest cross bar, the two axle plates (one of them the outer plate of the chain case), the case inner plate, its band and spacers, the skid standoffs, the two spiders with their hubs and stub axles, the two shafts cut from keyed stock and the two component uprights. The plates and spiders are laser cut to the outlines in

their making sketches. Everything else is bought and fitted: the frame, bearings, sprockets, chains, gearmotor, wheels, electronics, pack, controls, skids and strap. The work is cutting, drilling and coping steel tube, MIG welding to the frame, bending thin aluminium sheet, bolting, and wiring bought modules at 24 V. The parts are estimated at USD 776 from the bill of materials.

Safety: The finished truck moves a load of up to 60 kg on a stair with a person uphill of it, has a 182 N·m drive, two chain stages and turning clusters, and carries a 256 Wh lithium iron phosphate pack. Keep the pack out until section 6 says otherwise. Welding needs a welding helmet, gloves, a fire-safe area and good ventilation; strip paint and zinc from the weld areas first. Cut steel and aluminium edges are sharp: deburr everything. No climb with a load and no stair work is part of this plan.

■ 2. What changed to make it buildable

The concept showed what the truck does; several of its parts could not be made, fitted or fixed as drawn. Each change below keeps what the truck does, and all of them are recorded in decision record SCM-DDR-003, open for Amish's review.

Table 1. Changes from the concept.

Component	The concept had	The buildable design has	Why
Shaft bearings	Bearings drawn inside the rails and the cluster hubs	Two axle plates welded inside the rails, a flange bearing bolted to the inside of each (Figure 5)	There is no room outside the rails for a bearing, hub, spider and wheel within the 600 mm width
Countershaft	One bearing, half inside a rail, both sprockets overhung	A bearing on each chain case plate, both sprockets between them (Figure 11)	A shaft with 4.5 kN of chain pull needs support on both sides
Chain guards	Loose rings and strips with open sides	A closed chain case: outer plate, aluminium inner plate on two spacers, aluminium band (Figures 4, 9, 11 and 13)	The guard is fixed, encloses both chains and carries the countershaft and gearmotor
Lowest cross bar	60 mm above the shaft line, through the chain and the axle plates	Cut off; a new bar 105 mm below the shaft line (Figure 2)	Clears the chain case
Countershaft and gearmotor	On the shaft line, the large sprocket standing past the front of the rails	15 mm toward the back	The load sits against flat rails; nothing reaches into it
Chain centres	Distances that needed part links	Distances for 38 and 54 whole links, with 8 mm slots to tension each chain	Chains come in whole links
Gearmotor	Motor parallel to the output, floating	Motor standing up the frame at right angles, gearbox face bolted to the case inner plate (Figure 10)	How a worm gearmotor is made, and a fixing where its torque reacts
Cluster hubs and wheels	No axles; hubs and wheels unfixed	Weld-on taper-lock hubs, welded stub axles, wheels held by a spacer, washer and end screw (Figures 14 to 16)	Bought hubs give a clamped, keyed fit without machining
Electronics box, pack, fuse box	Floating behind the rails	Two aluminium uprights bolted through the cross bars carry them (Figures 17 and 18)	Light, bolted, nothing welded to aluminium
Skids	Long strips on thin rods	500 mm skids on four welded square-tube standoffs (Figures 7 and 8)	Straight, strong supports from the rails; skid face unchanged
Handle controls, strap, harness	Floating	Pod clamped round the grip, strap hooked round the rails, cables tied along the uprights	Every part has a fixing

■ 3. Making the components

Make and check each component before the assembly step that needs it. Sizes are in millimetres. "Up" is along the rails toward the handle, "back" is toward the stair side (the side the electronics hang on), "forward" is toward the load. "Left" and "right" are as seen standing at the back of the truck, looking at the electronics; the drive side is the right. Every height is measured from the **shaft line**, the line through the centre of the cluster shaft, 142.5 mm above the top of the toe plate and 40 mm behind the rail centre lines. Workshop tolerance is 0.5 mm unless a step says otherwise; drawings do not carry tolerances before TRL 4.

3.1 Frame changes and the replacement lowest cross bar

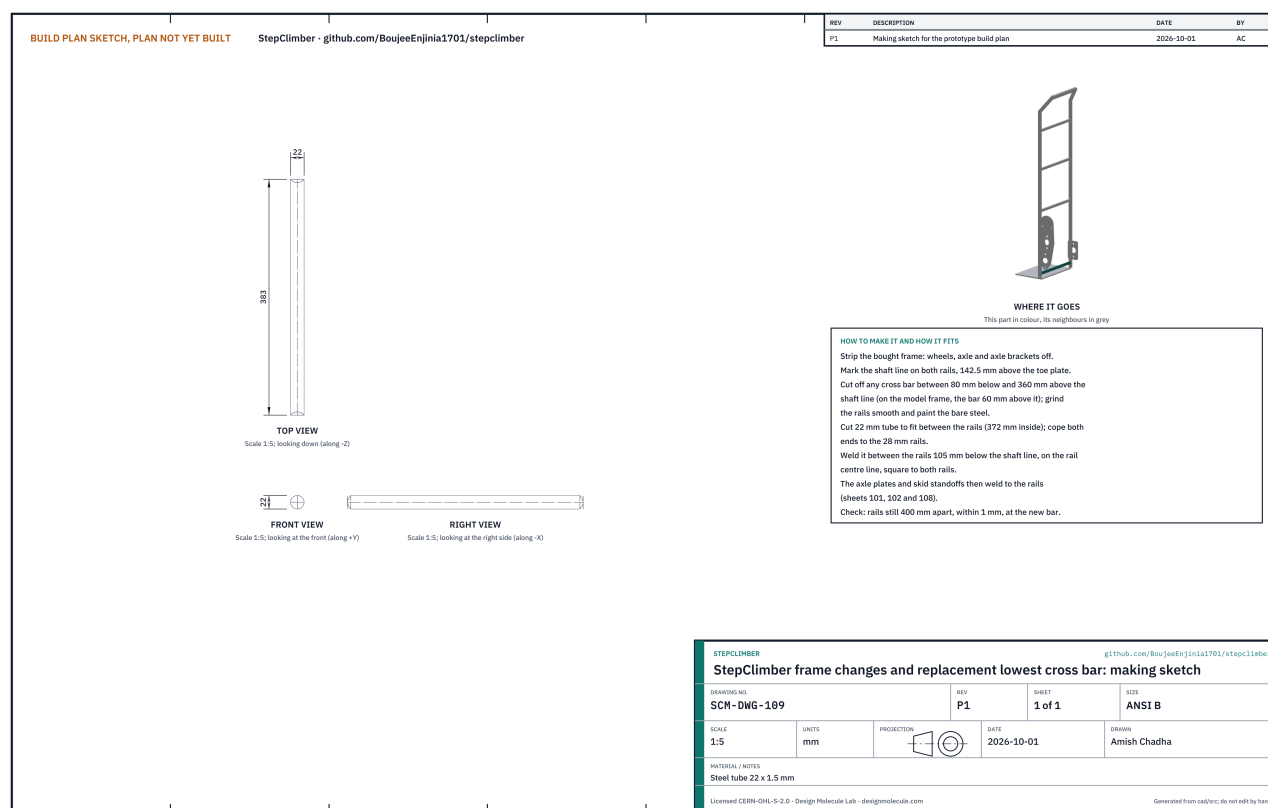


Figure 2. Frame changes and replacement lowest cross bar (SCM-DWG-109).

What it is and what it is made from. The bought hand truck is a steel loop-handle frame with 28 mm rails 400 mm apart and a 380 x 240 mm toe plate. Its lowest cross bar would pass through the chain case, so it is replaced by one lower down, cut from 22 x 1.5 mm steel tube.

How to make it.

1. Take the wheels, axle and axle brackets off the frame.
2. Measure 142.5 mm up each rail from the top of the toe plate and mark the shaft line all round both rails.
3. Cut off any cross bar between 80 mm below and 360 mm above the shaft line (on the frame modelled, the one 60 mm above it). Grind the rails smooth.
4. Cut a length of 22 mm tube to fit between the rails (372 mm inside) and cope both ends to the 28 mm rails.
5. Weld it between the rails 105 mm below the shaft line, on the rail centre lines, square to both rails.
6. Paint the bare steel except where the axle plates and skid standoffs will be welded.

How it fits the parts next to it. The new bar sits 22 mm below the bottom of the chain case and 26 mm above the toe plate (step 1). The three upper cross bars, about 380, 700 and 1,000 mm above the shaft line, carry the component uprights later.

Check before moving on. The rails are still 400 mm apart, within 1 mm, at the new bar and at the top.

3.2 Axle plate, plain side

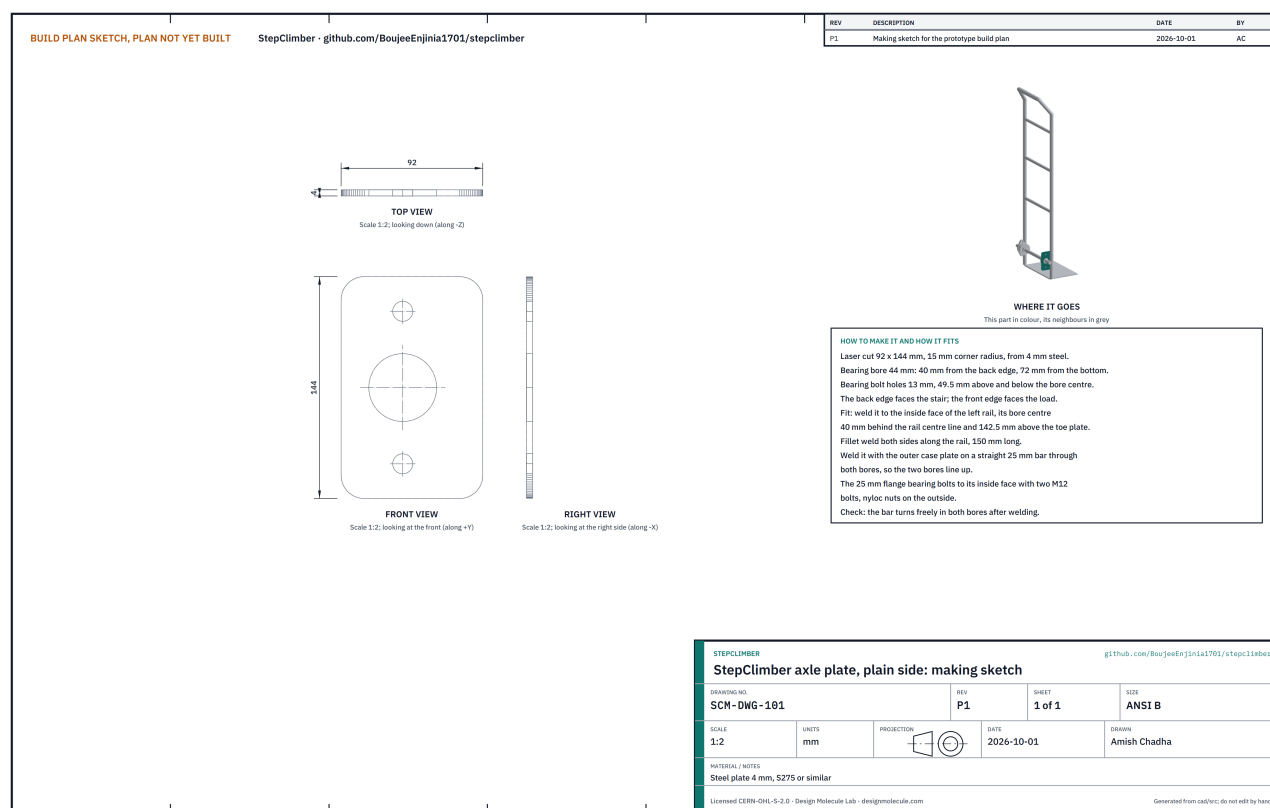
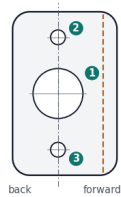


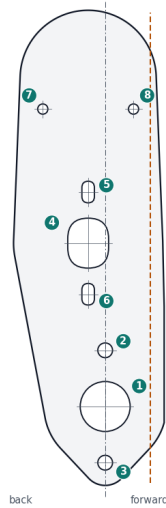
Figure 3. Plain-side axle plate making sketch (SCM-DWG-101).

Axle plate and chain case plates: hole layout

Each plate drawn flat with the load side (forward) to the right and the stair side (back) to the left. Figures in mm, measured from the main shaft centre: up the plate, and back or forward of it. Slots run up the plate.

Axle plate, plain side (4 mm steel)

- 1 Bearing bore 44, at 0, 0
 - 2 Bearing bolt hole 13, 49.5 up
 - 3 Bearing bolt hole 13, 49.5 down
- Plate 92 x 144, corners 15 radius; bore 40 from the back edge and 72 from the bottom.
Dashed line: weld to the inside of the rail, 40 forward.

Case outer plate (3 mm steel)

- 1 Main bearing bore 44, at 0, 0
 - 2, 3 Bearing bolt holes 13, 49.5 up and down
 - 4 Countershaft slot 36 wide, 8 long: 143.9 up, 15 back
 - 5, 6 Its bolt slots 11 wide, 8 long, 45 above and below 4
 - 7 Spacer hole 9: 262 up, 55 back (countersunk outside)
 - 8 Spacer hole 9: 262 up, 25 forward (countersunk outside)
- Dashed line: weld to the inside of the rail, 40 forward.

Case inner plate (3 mm aluminium)

- 1 Shaft clearance hole 32, at 0, 0 (no bearing here)
 - 2 to 4 Countershaft slots as the outer plate; bolt slots 3 and 4 countersunk on the case side
 - 5, 6 Spacer holes 9, as the outer plate
 - 7 Gearmotor output hole 28: 289 up, 15 back
 - 8 to 10 Gearmotor screw slots 9 wide, 8 long: 40 either side of 7 and 40 above it
- Same outline as the outer plate; no weld.

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Figure 4. Every hole in the axle plate and the two chain case plates, measured from the main shaft centre.

What it is and what it is made from. The plate that carries the left-hand shaft bearing, welded to the inside of the left rail. Steel plate 4 mm, laser cut.

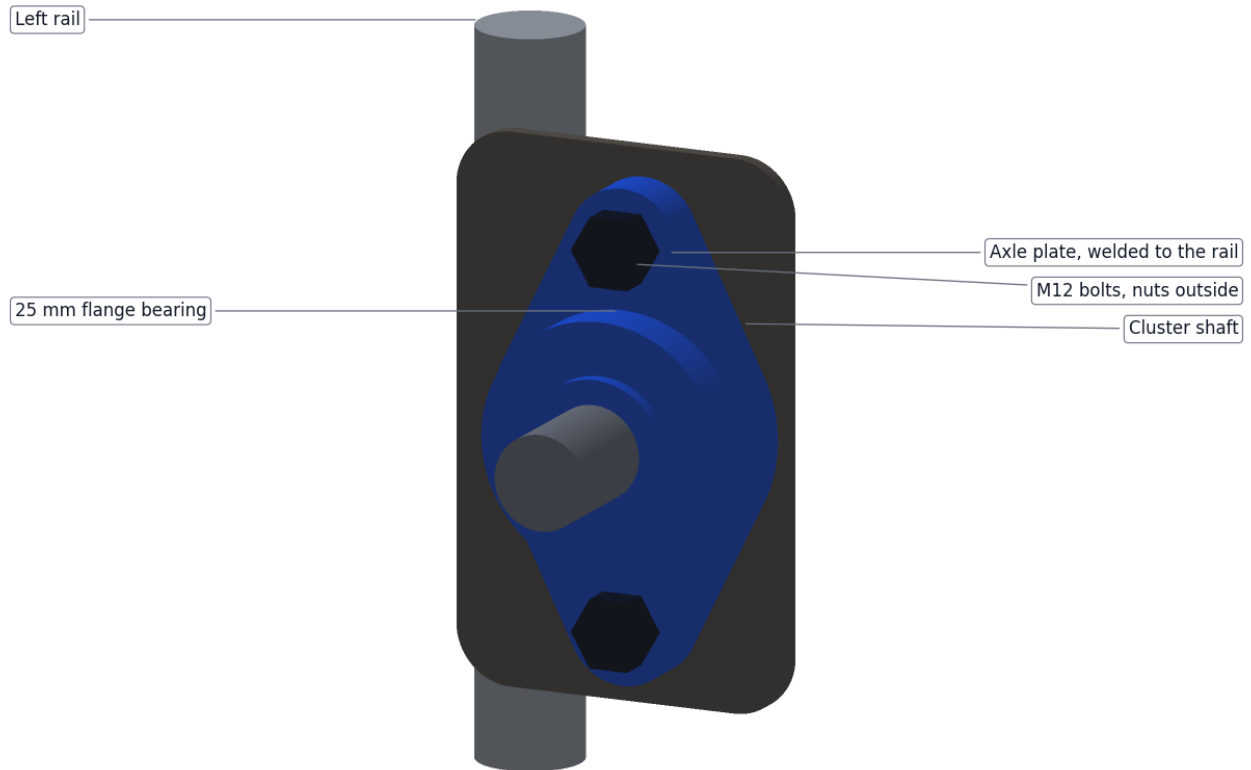
How to make it.

1. Have it laser cut 92 x 144 mm with 15 mm corners, a 44 mm bearing bore 40 mm from the back edge and 72 mm from the bottom, and two 13 mm bolt holes 49.5 mm above and below the bore (Figure 4, left).
2. Deburr. Clean the weld edge and the rail back to bright steel.
3. Cut a straight 25 mm bar about 600 mm long to use as an alignment bar for this plate and the chain case outer plate (section 3.3).

How it fits the parts next to it.

Joint 1: axle plate and main bearing, plain side

Seen from inside the truck. The plate is welded to the inside of the rail; the bearing bolts to its inside face



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Figure 5. Seen from inside the truck: the plate is welded to the inside of the rail and the bearing bolts to its inside face.

The plate lies flat against the inside of the left rail with its bore centre on the shaft line, 40 mm behind the rail centre line. Weld it along the rail on both sides of the plate, 150 mm of fillet each side, with the alignment bar through its bore and the outer plate's bore (step 2). The 25 mm two-bolt flange bearing bolts to its inside face with two M12 bolts, nyloc nuts on the outside (step 4).

Check before moving on. After welding, the alignment bar turns freely in both bores.

3.3 Chain case outer plate

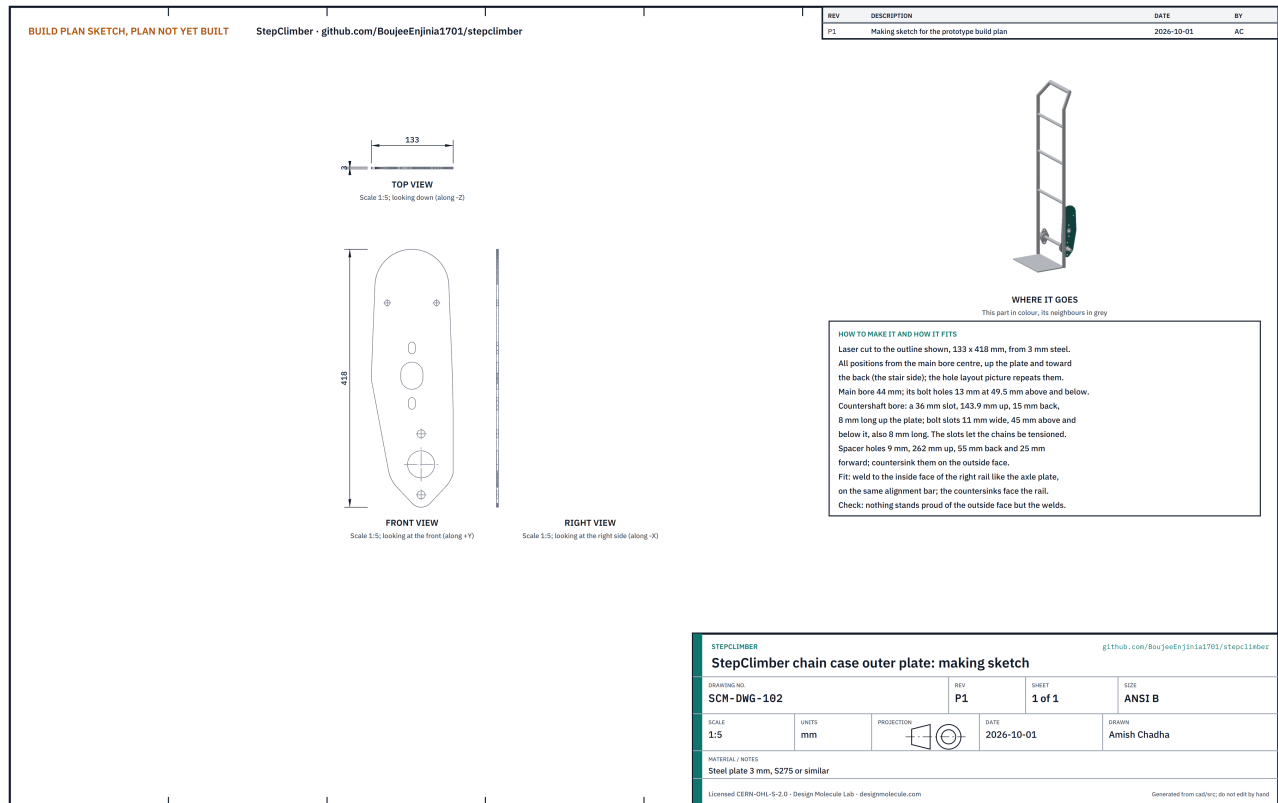


Figure 6. Chain case outer plate making sketch (SCM-DWG-102).

What it is and what it is made from. The drive-side axle plate and the outside wall of the chain case. It carries the right-hand shaft bearing and the outer countershaft bearing. Steel plate 3 mm, laser cut to the outline in Figure 6, 133 x 418 mm.

How to make it.

1. Have it laser cut to the outline with the holes in Figure 4 (middle): the 44 mm main bore and its two 13 mm bolt holes; a 36 mm countershaft slot 143.9 mm up and 15 mm back, 8 mm long up the plate, with two 11 mm bolt slots 45 mm above and below it, also 8 mm long; two 9 mm spacer holes 262 mm up, 55 mm back and 25 mm forward.
2. Countersink the two spacer holes on the face that will go against the rail (the outside face).
3. Deburr; clean the weld edge.

How it fits the parts next to it. The plate lies flat against the inside of the right rail, its main bore on the shaft line, welded like the axle plate on the same alignment bar (step 2). Its outline keeps 54 mm round the shaft line and 66 mm round the countershaft on the stair side, so no part of it comes within 10 mm of a stair nosing during a climb. On the load side it stops 2 mm behind the front of the rail. Bearings bolt to its inside face (step 4); the case band sits against the same face round its edge (step 10).

Check before moving on. Nothing stands proud of the outside face but the welds; the countershaft slot and its bolt slots run up the plate, parallel to the rail.

3.4 Skid standoffs and skids

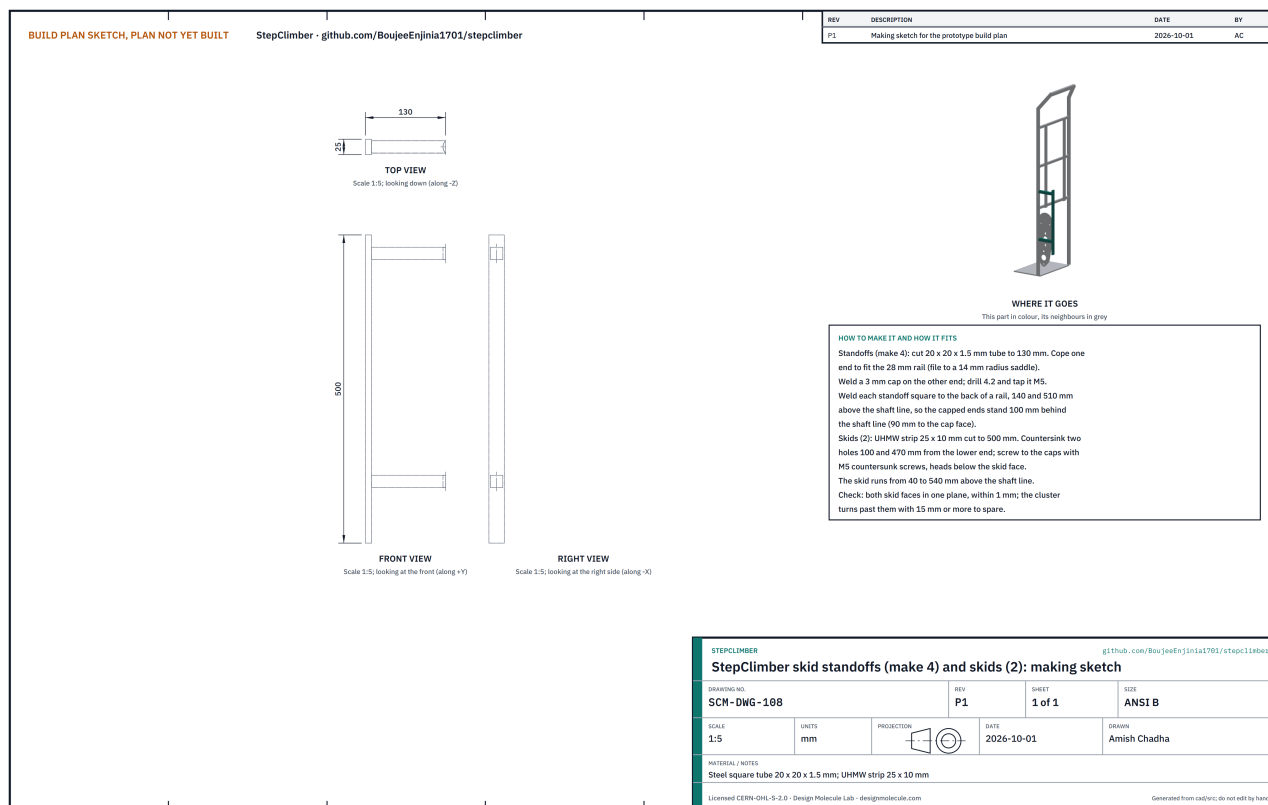


Figure 7. Skid standoffs and skids making sketch (SCM-DWG-108).

What it is and what it is made from. Four short arms welded to the backs of the rails that hold two plastic skids 100 mm behind the shaft line, where they keep the frame off the stair nosings. Steel square tube 20 x 20 x 1.5 mm with 3 mm plate caps; ultra-high molecular weight polyethylene (UHMW) strip 25 x 10 mm.

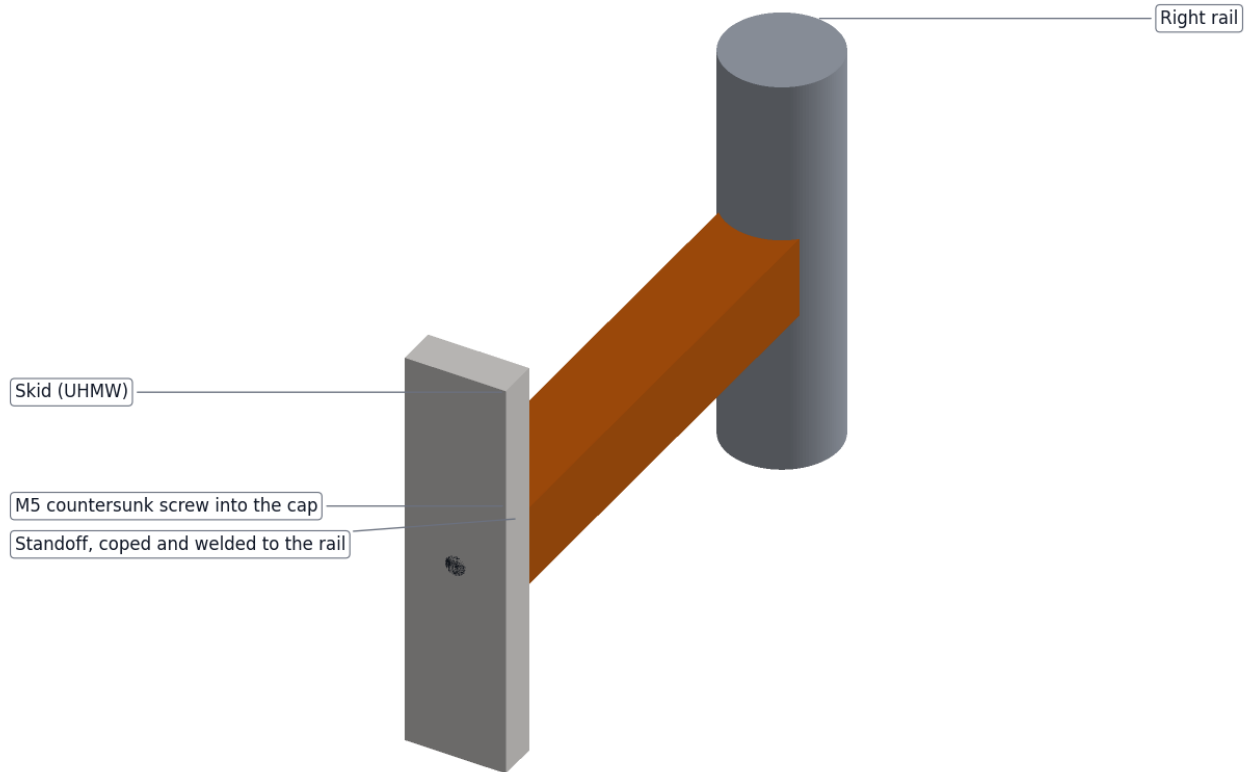
How to make it.

1. Cut four 130 mm lengths of square tube. Cope one end of each to fit the 28 mm rail: scribe a 14 mm radius saddle and file to it.
2. Weld a 3 mm cap on the other end of each; drill 4.2 mm in the middle of the cap and tap M5.
3. Cut two 500 mm lengths of UHMW strip. Drill and countersink two 5.5 mm holes in each, 100 and 470 mm from the lower end.

How it fits the parts next to it.

Joint 7: skid on its standoff (drive side, lower standoff)

Seen from above and behind. The skid face is 100 mm behind the shaft line



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Figure 8. The coped end of the standoff is welded to the back of the rail; the skid screws to its cap.

The standoffs weld square to the backs of the rails, two on each rail, 140 and 510 mm above the shaft line, pointing straight back (step 3). Their caps then lie 90 mm behind the shaft line, and the skids, screwed to them with M5 countersunk screws, stand from 40 to 540 mm above it with their faces 100 mm behind it (step 16). The turning clusters pass the standoffs and skids with 15 mm to spare.

Check before moving on. Both skid faces lie in one plane, within 1 mm.

3.5 Chain case inner plate and spacers

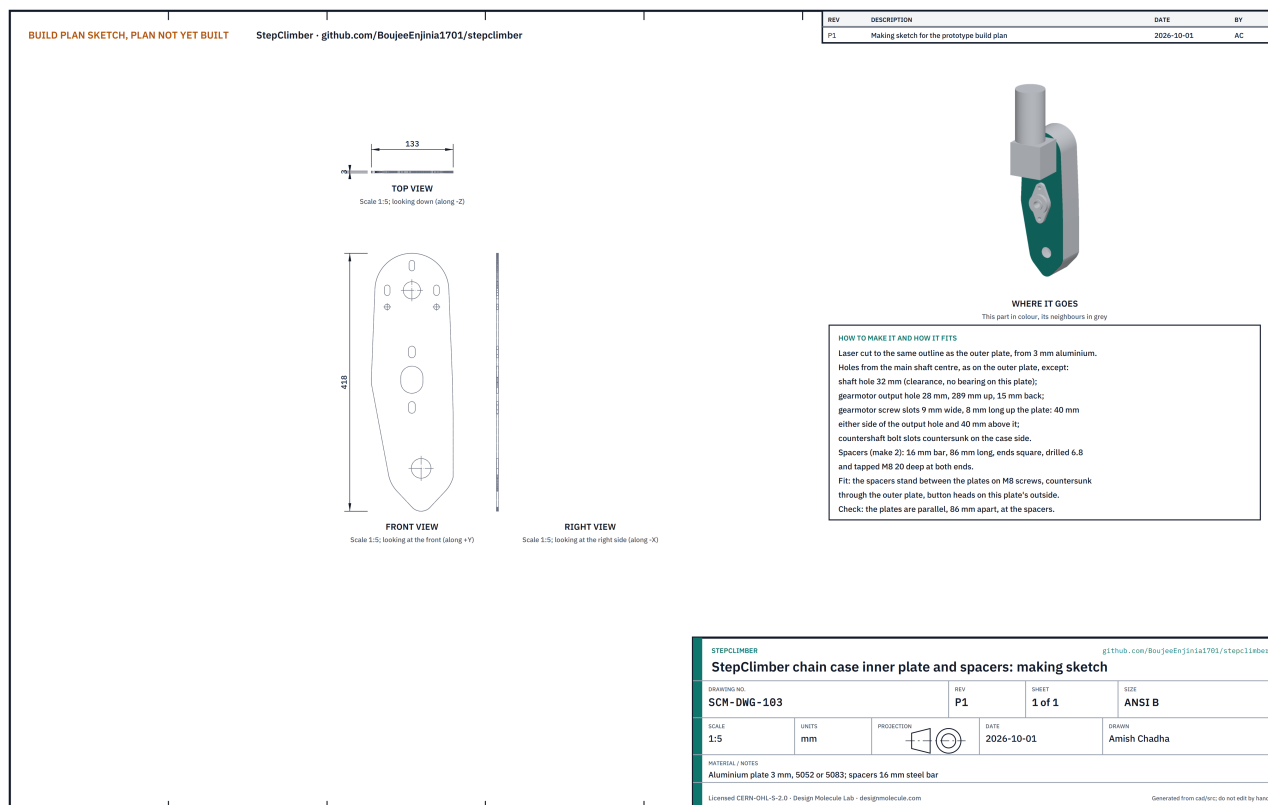


Figure 9. Chain case inner plate and spacers making sketch (SCM-DWG-103).

What it is and what it is made from. The inside wall of the chain case. It carries the inner countershaft bearing and the gearmotor, and comes off to reach the chains. Aluminium plate 3 mm (5052 or 5083), laser cut to the same outline as the outer plate; two spacers from 16 mm steel bar.

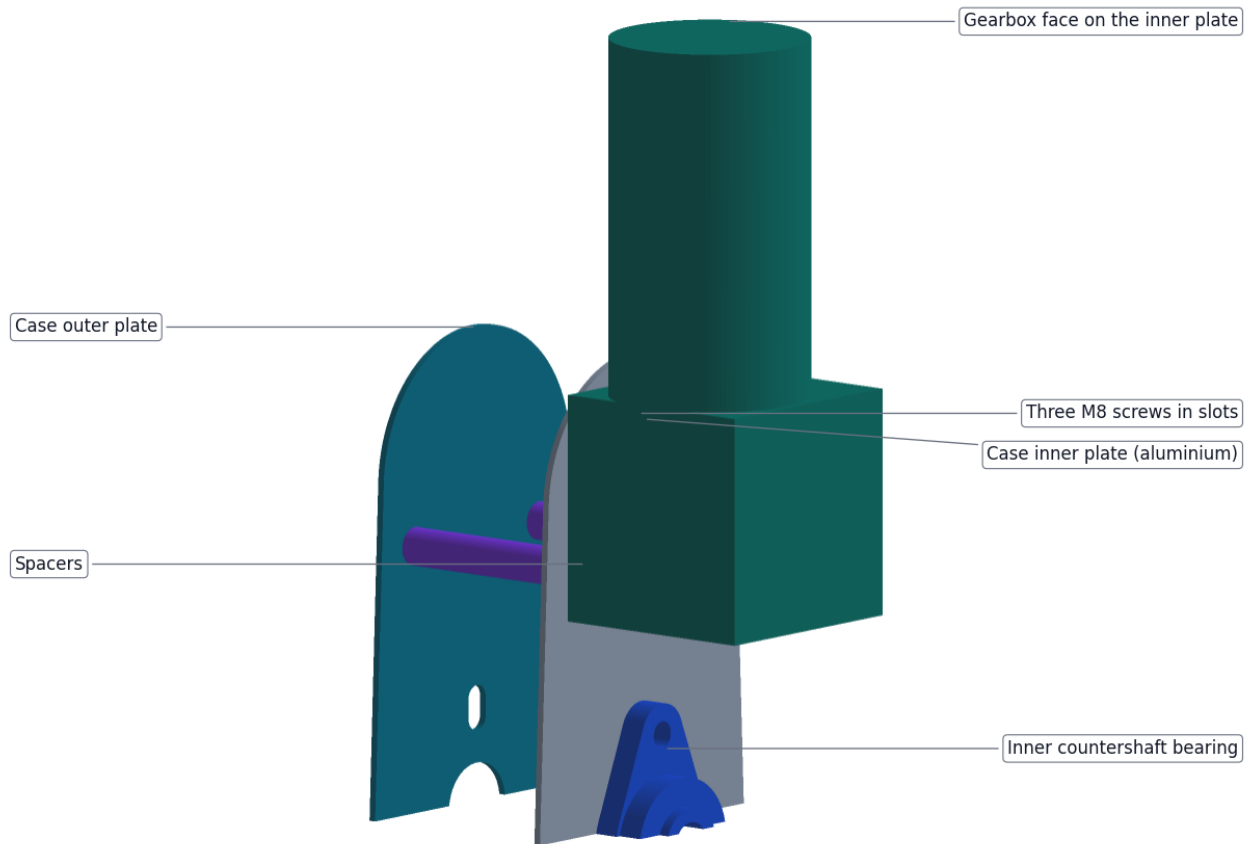
How to make it.

1. Have the plate laser cut with the holes in Figure 4 (right): a 32 mm clearance hole for the shaft (no bearing on this plate); the countershaft slot and bolt slots as on the outer plate; the two 9 mm spacer holes; a 28 mm hole for the gearmotor output 289 mm up and 15 mm back; three 9 mm gearmotor screw slots, 8 mm long up the plate, 40 mm either side of the output hole and 40 mm above it.
2. Countersink the two countershaft bolt slots on the case side (the side facing the outer plate).
3. Spacers (make 2): cut 16 mm bar to 86 mm, face the ends square, drill 6.8 mm and tap M8 20 deep in both ends.

How it fits the parts next to it.

Joint 3: worm gearmotor on the chain case inner plate

Seen from inside the truck and behind. The motor stands up the frame; its output shaft passes into the case



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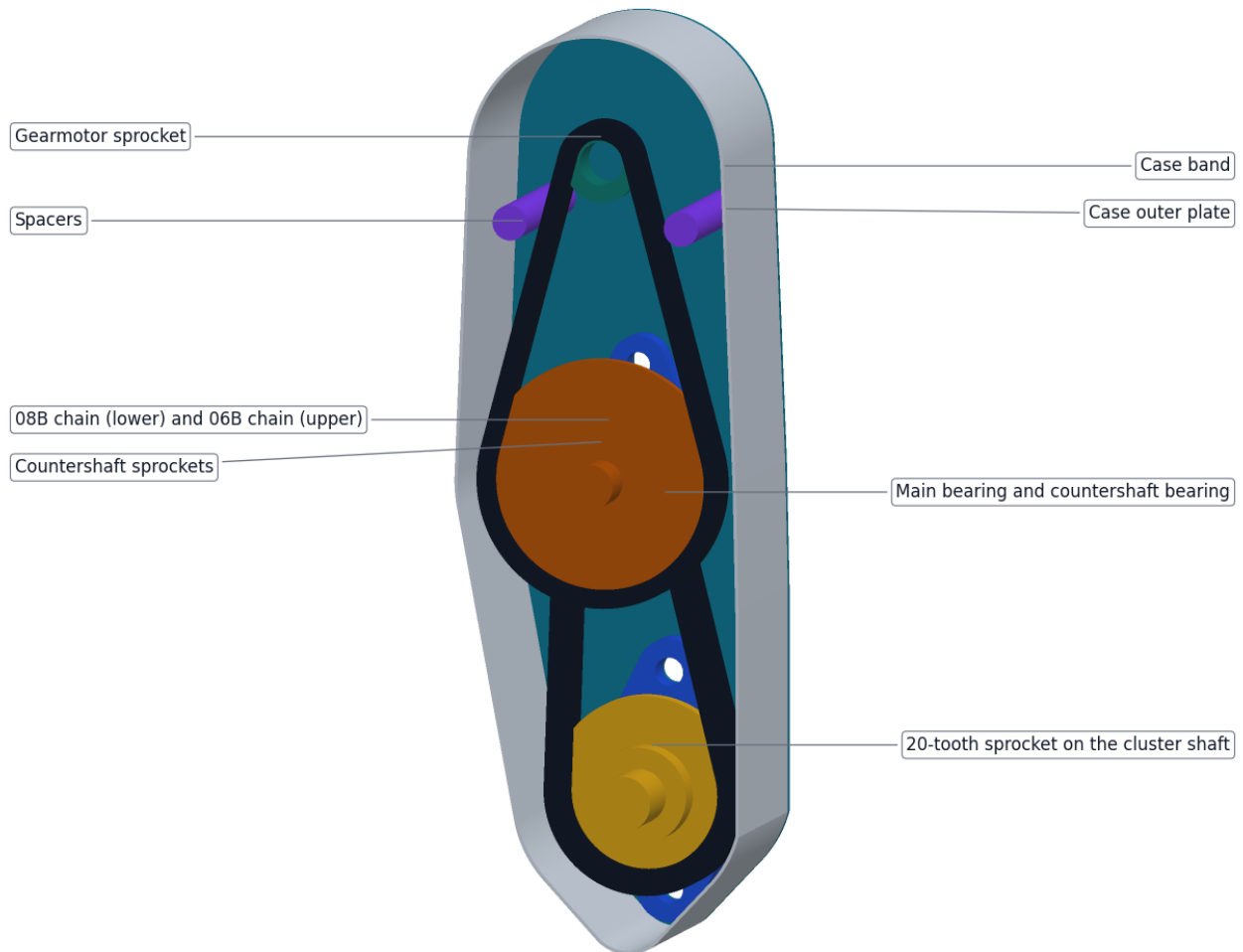
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Figure 10. Seen from inside the truck and behind: the gearbox face bolts to the inner plate; the motor stands up the frame.

The plate stands 86 mm inside the outer plate on the two spacers, held by M8 countersunk screws through the outer plate and M8 button-head screws on the inner plate (step 5). The inner countershaft bearing bolts to its gearbox side with countersunk M10 screws from the case side, nuts on the bearing flange. The gearmotor bolts to the same side with three M8 screws through the slots; its output shaft passes through the 28 mm hole into the case (step 8).

Joint 2: inside the chain case (inner plate and gearmotor left off)

Seen from inside the truck. Both chains run between the plates; the band closes the edge all round



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Figure 11. Joint 2: inside the chain case, inner plate and gearmotor left off. The final-stage chain runs from the countershaft down to the shaft; the first-stage chain runs from the gearmotor down to the countershaft.

Check before moving on. On a trial fit with the spacers, the plates are parallel and 86 mm apart at both spacers.

3.6 Cluster shaft and countershaft

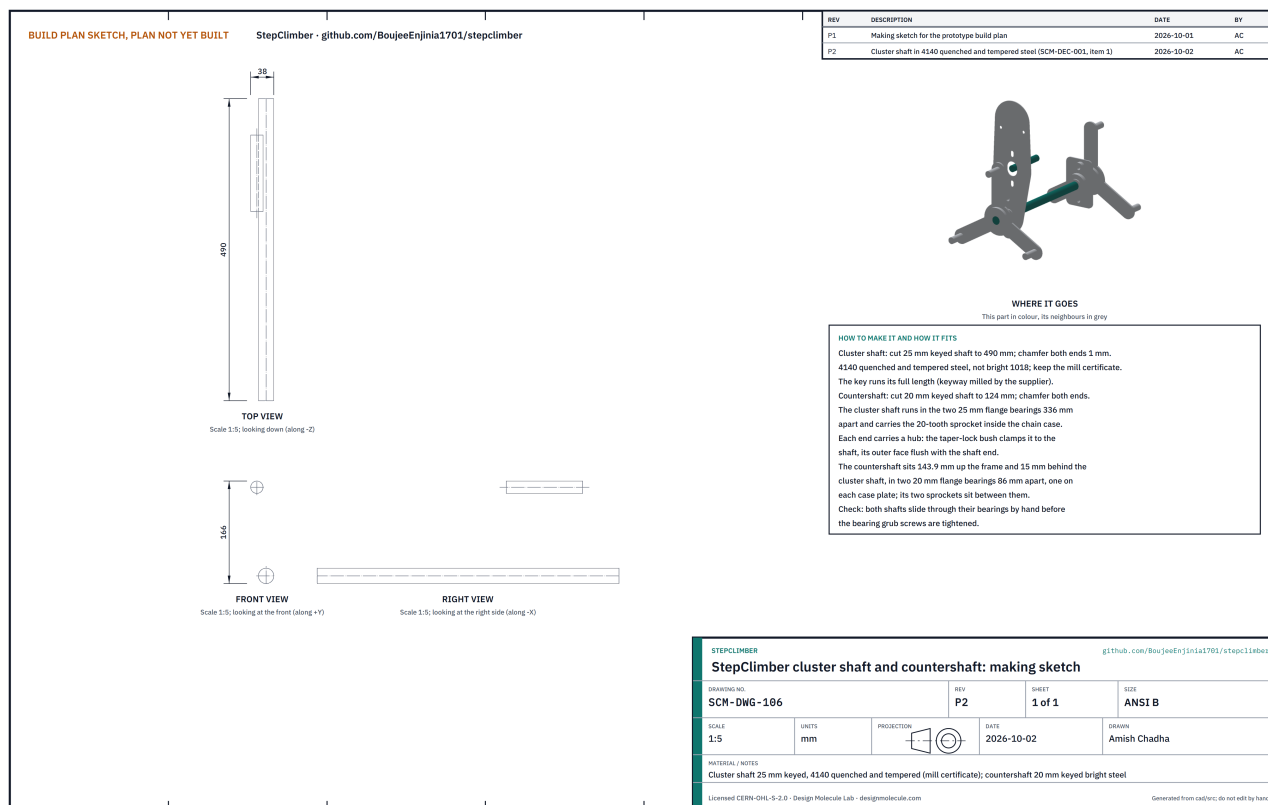


Figure 12. Cluster shaft and countershaft making sketch (SCM-DWG-106).

What it is and what it is made from. The cluster shaft carries both clusters and the 20-tooth final sprocket; the countershaft carries the two middle sprockets. Bought keyed shaft with keys: the 25 mm cluster shaft in quenched and tempered alloy steel such as 4140 (not 1018 bright bar), with a mill certificate, and have the supplier mill the keyway; the 20 mm countershaft in bright steel. The 4140 shaft is about 12 dollars dearer than bright 1018 bar and about 2.5 times as strong against a dropped step (a safety factor of 2.5 against 1.4), so do not swap in a softer bar.

How to make it.

1. Cut the 25 mm keyed shaft to 490 mm; chamfer both ends 1 mm.
2. Cut the 20 mm keyed shaft to 124 mm; chamfer both ends.
3. Cut keys to length for each sprocket and hub.

How it fits the parts next to it. The cluster shaft runs in the two 25 mm flange bearings, 336 mm apart, and sticks out 59 mm beyond each axle plate to carry a hub; the hub's outer face is flush with the shaft end. Inside the case it carries the 20-tooth 08B sprocket. The countershaft runs in the two 20 mm flange bearings, 86 mm apart, one on each case plate, and carries the 35-tooth 06B sprocket and the 10-tooth 08B sprocket between them, hub to hub. Each shaft is located by the grub screws or collars of its bearing inserts.

Check before moving on. Each shaft slides through its bearings and sprockets by hand before any grub screw is tightened.

3.7 Chain case band

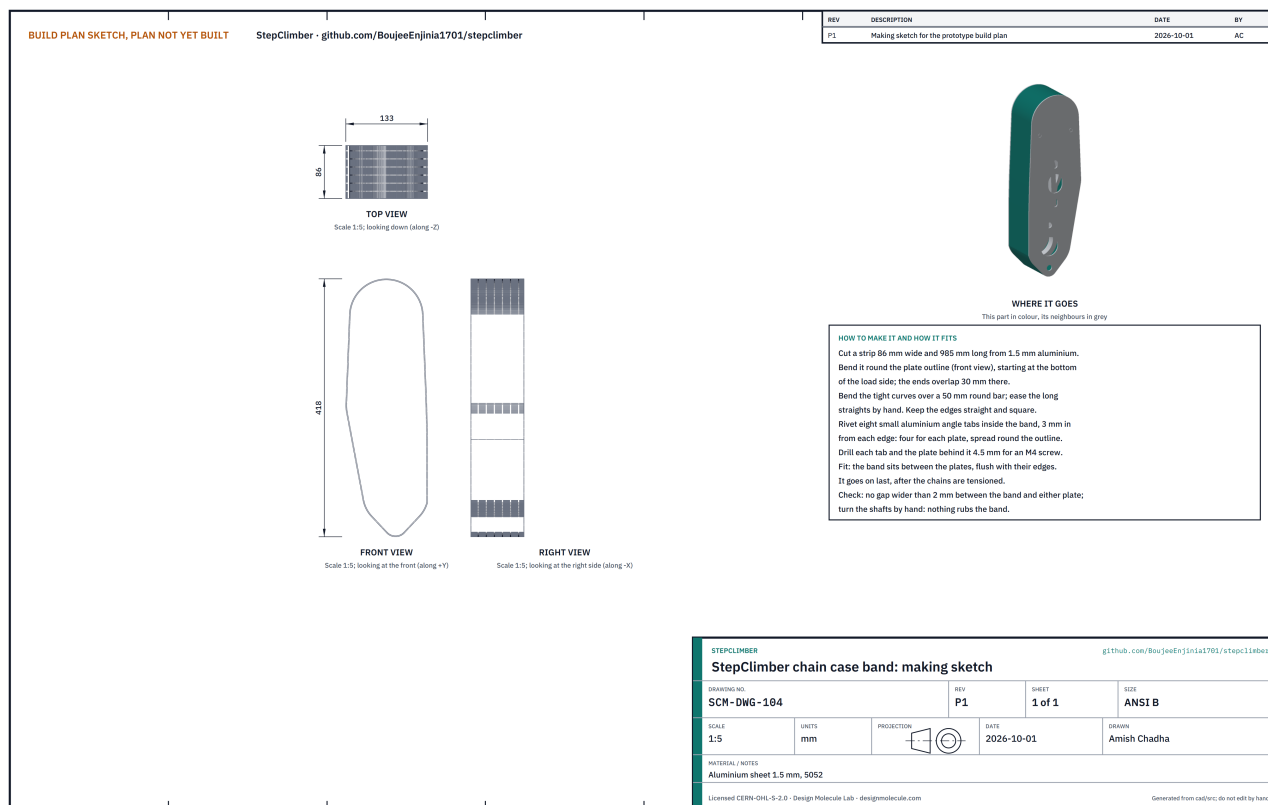


Figure 13. Chain case band making sketch (SCM-DWG-104).

What it is and what it is made from. The strip that closes the edge of the chain case all round. Aluminium sheet 1.5 mm (5052), 86 mm wide, with eight small aluminium angle tabs.

How to make it.

1. Cut a strip 86 mm wide and 985 mm long.
2. Starting at the bottom of the load side, bend it round the plate outline: the tight curves over a 50 mm round bar, the long straights by hand, checking against the outer plate as you go. The ends overlap 30 mm; rivet them together.
3. Rivet eight small angle tabs inside the band, 3 mm in from its edges: four along each edge, spread round the outline.
4. Hold the band between the two plates, drill each tab and the plate behind it 4.5 mm, and fit M4 screws.

How it fits the parts next to it. The band sits between the plates, flush with their edges, held by the M4 screws through its tabs into both plates. It goes on last, after the chains are tensioned (step 10), and comes off with the inner plate for chain work.

Check before moving on. No gap wider than 2 mm between the band and either plate; turning the shafts by hand, nothing rubs the band.

3.8 Spiders with weld-on hubs and stub axles (make 2)

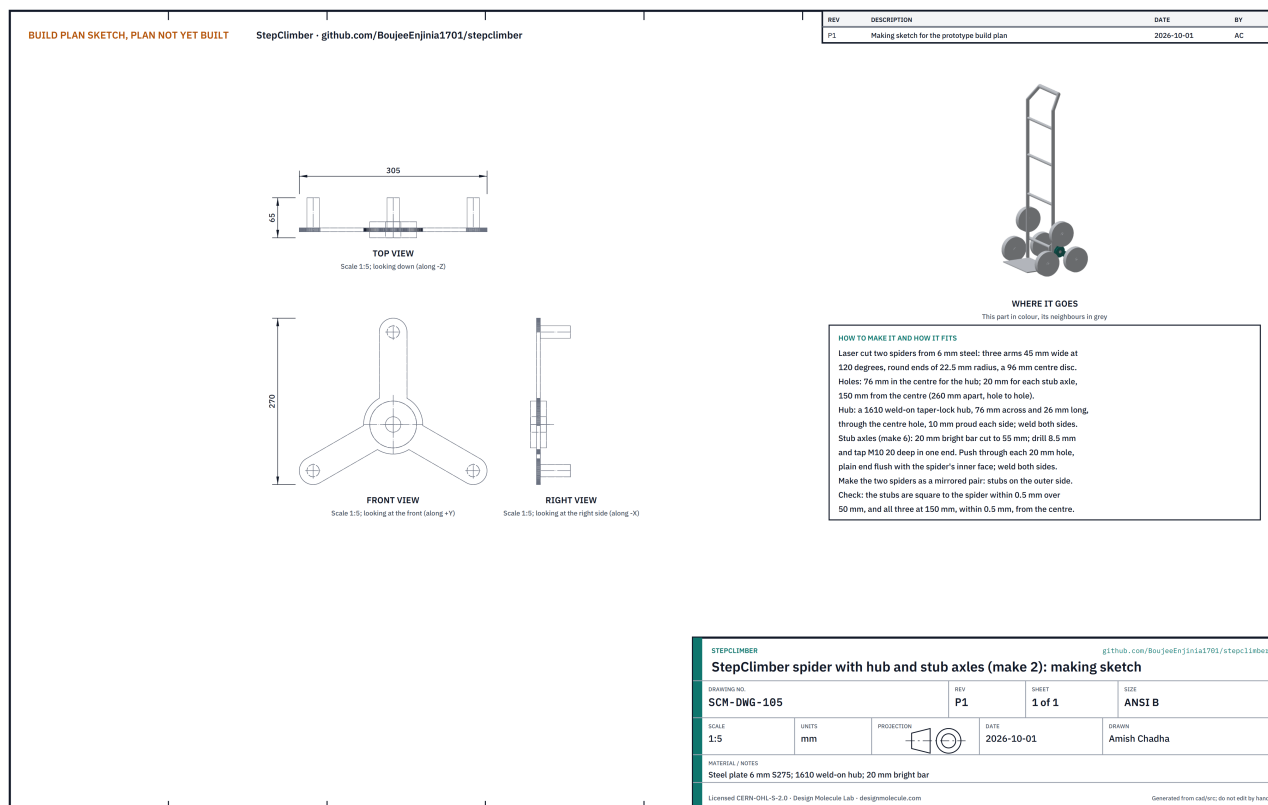


Figure 14. Spider with hub and stub axles making sketch (SCM-DWG-105).

What it is and what it is made from. Each cluster's three-armed frame. Steel plate 6 mm (S275), laser cut; a 1610 weld-on taper-lock hub with a 25 mm keyed bush; three stub axles from 20 mm bright bar.

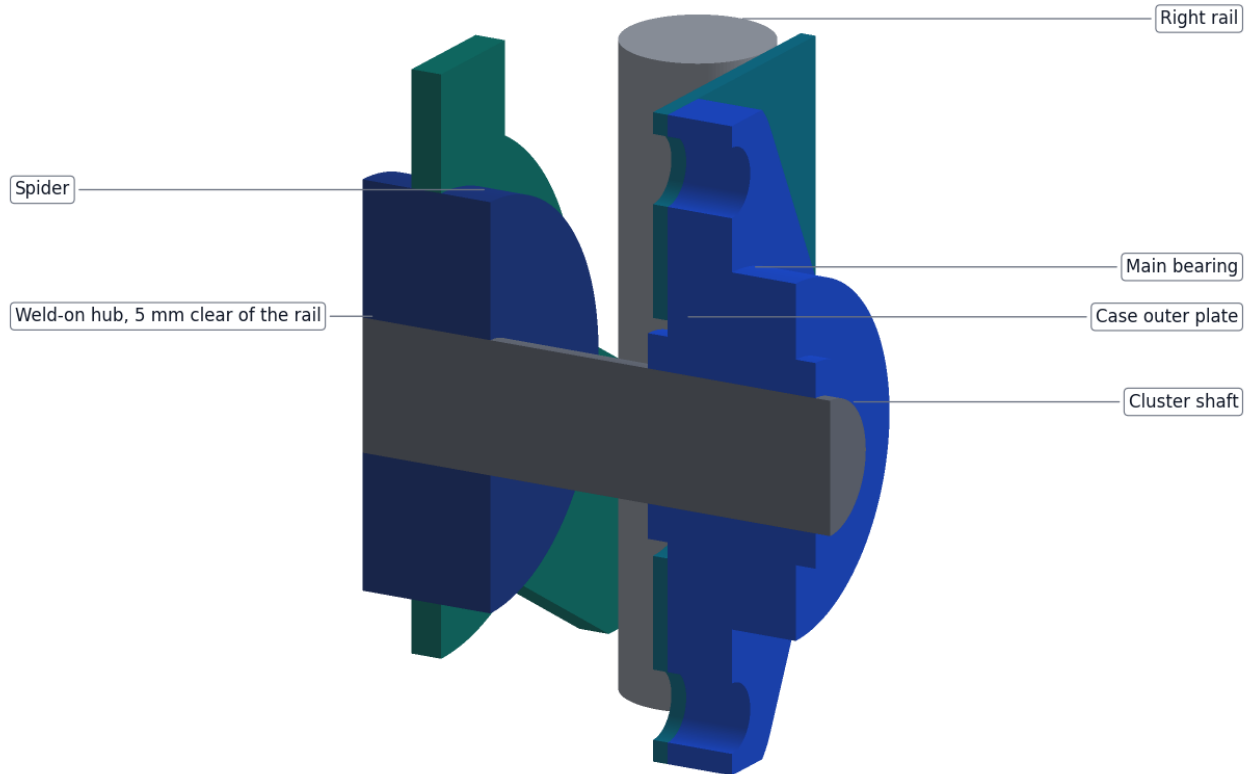
How to make it.

1. Have two spiders laser cut: three arms 45 mm wide at 120°, round ends of 22.5 mm radius, a 96 mm centre disc, a 76 mm centre hole and three 20 mm axle holes 150 mm from the centre (260 mm apart, hole to hole).
2. Push a weld-on hub through the centre hole so it stands 10 mm proud each side, square to the plate, and weld it both sides.
3. Stub axles (make 6): cut 20 mm bar to 55 mm; drill 8.5 mm and tap M10 20 deep in one end.
4. Push a stub axle through each 20 mm hole, plain end flush with the spider's inner face and the tapped end outward, and weld both sides. Make the two spiders as a mirrored pair, stub axles on the outer side of each.

How it fits the parts next to it.

Joint 4: cluster hub on the shaft end (drive side, cut through the shaft)

Seen from the back. The taper-lock bush clamps the hub to the shaft; the hub clears the rail by 5 mm



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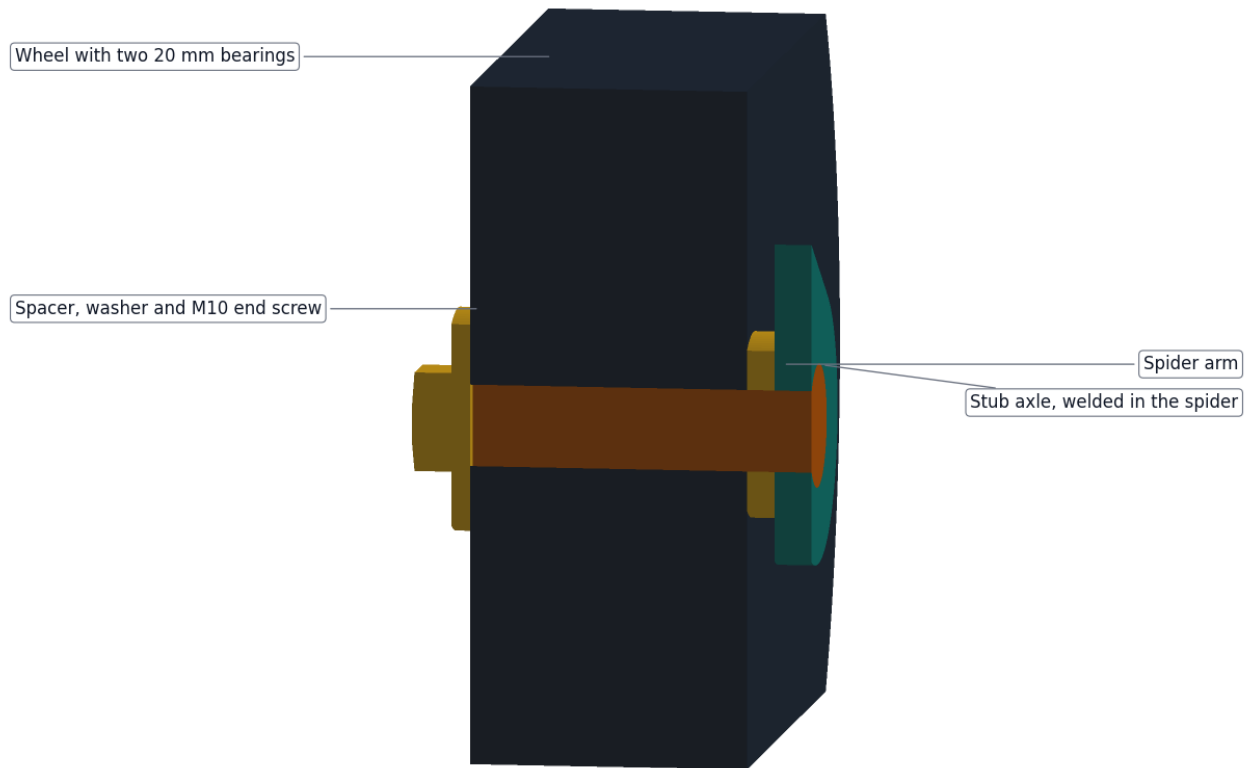
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Figure 15. Cut through the shaft: the taper-lock bush clamps the hub to the shaft end; the hub clears the rail by 5 mm.

The hub slides onto the shaft end over the key; tightening the taper-lock bush clamps it, with its outer face flush with the shaft end (step 11). The hub's inner face then stands 5 mm outside the rail, and the spider 15 mm.

Joint 5: wheel on its stub axle (cut through the axle)

Seen from the back, cut through the axle. The end screw clamps the bearing inner races between washer and spacer



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Figure 16. Cut through the axle: spacer, wheel, washer and end screw.

Each wheel runs on two 20 mm sealed bearings on a stub axle, between a 4.5 mm spacer against the spider and a 36 mm washer held by an M10 end screw (step 12). The stub axle is 0.5 mm shorter than the wheel and spacer together, so the screw clamps the bearing inner races and the wheel turns freely.

Check before moving on. The stub axles are square to the spider within 0.5 mm over 50 mm, and all three are 150 mm from the centre, within 0.5 mm.

3.9 Component uprights (make 2)

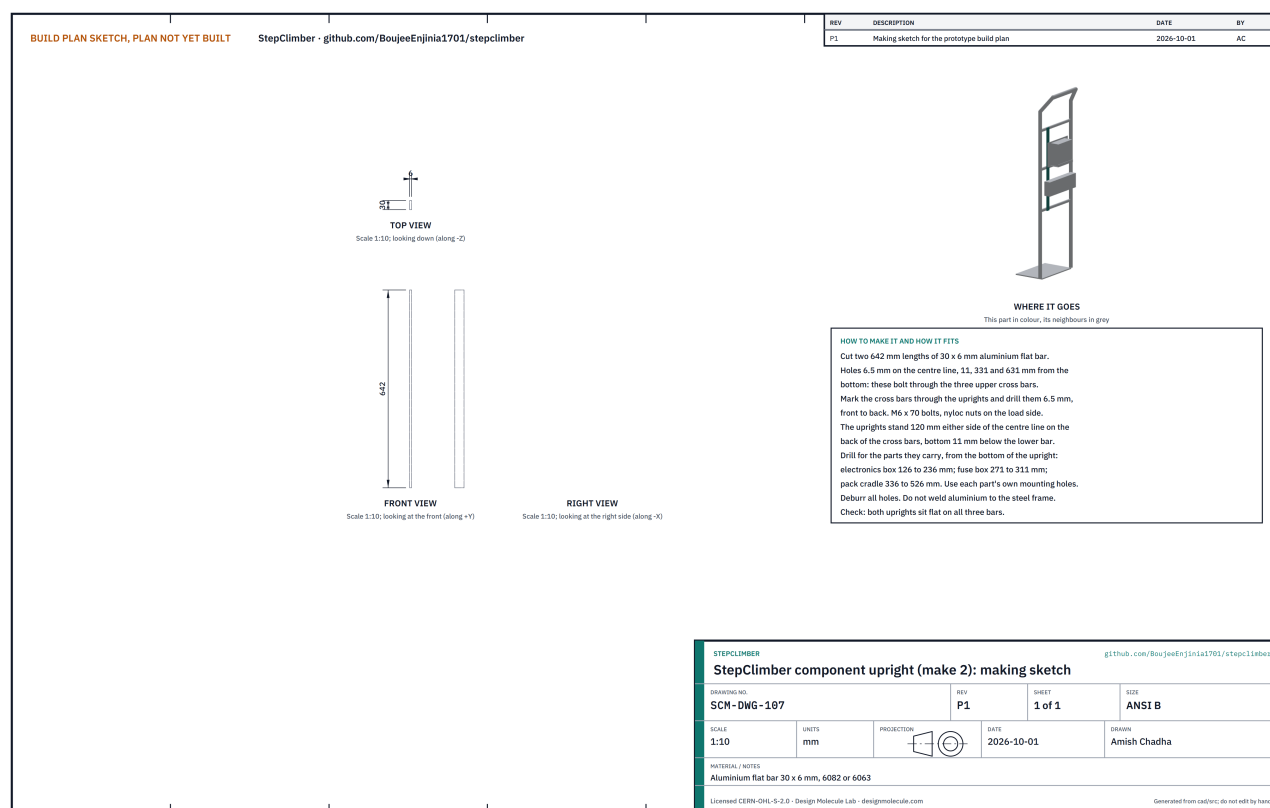


Figure 17. Component upright making sketch (SCM-DWG-107).

What it is and what it is made from. Two flat bars behind the frame that carry the electronics box, the fuse box and the pack cradle. Aluminium flat bar 30 x 6 mm (6082 or 6063).

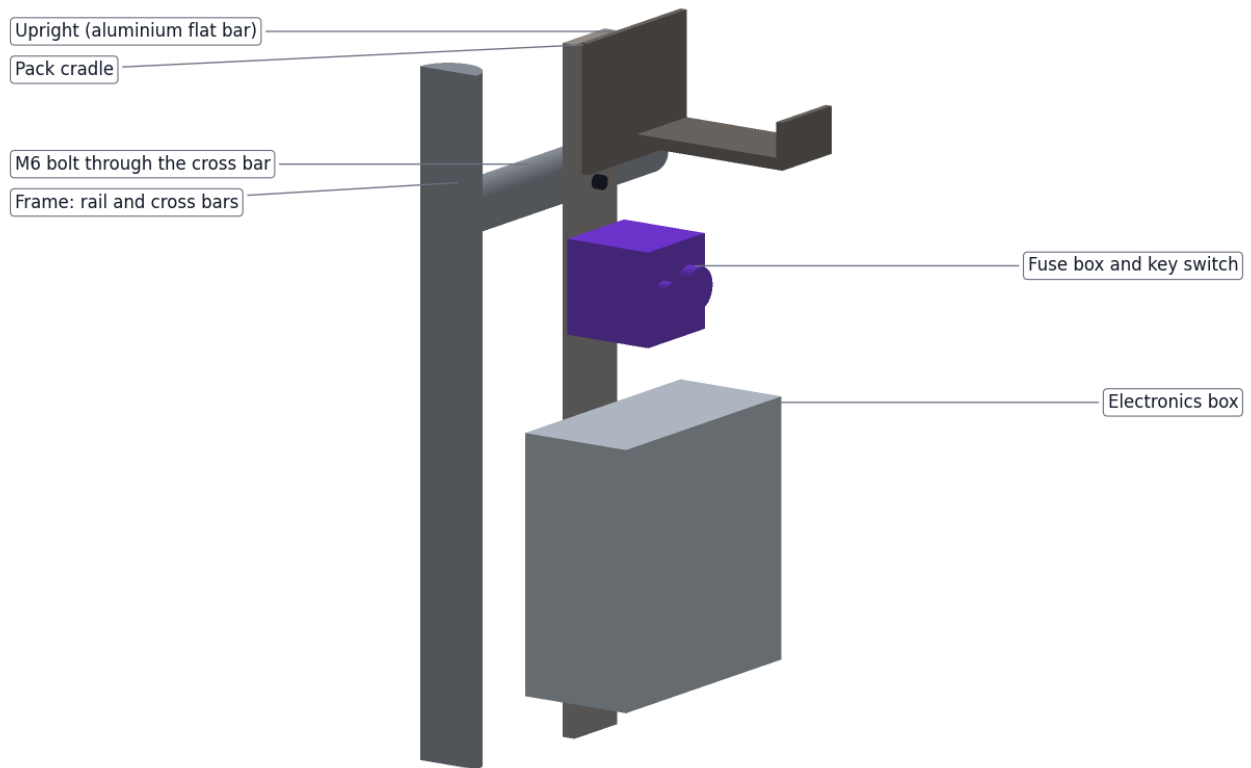
How to make it.

1. Cut two 642 mm lengths.
2. Drill three 6.5 mm holes on the centre line, 11, 331 and 631 mm from the bottom.
3. Drill for the parts they carry, using each part's own mounting holes, at these heights from the bottom of the upright: electronics box 126 to 236 mm, fuse box 271 to 311 mm (right-hand upright only), pack cradle 336 to 526 mm.
4. Deburr.

How it fits the parts next to it.

Joint 6: drive-side upright with the parts it carries

Seen from the drive side and behind. Each part bolts flat to the upright; the upright bolts to the back of the cross bars



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Figure 18. Seen from the drive side: the upright bolts to the back of the cross bars, and each part bolts flat to the upright.

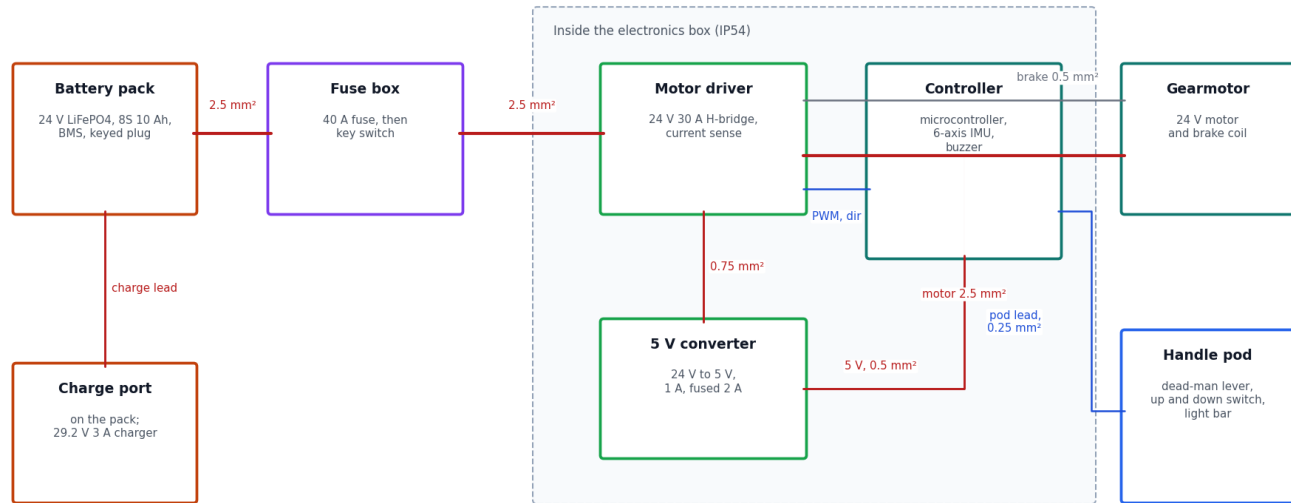
The uprights stand 120 mm either side of the centre line, flat against the backs of the three upper cross bars, the bottom 11 mm below the lowest of them. Mark the cross bars through the upright holes, drill them 6.5 mm front to back, and fit M6 x 70 bolts with nyloc nuts on the load side (step 13). Do not weld aluminium to the steel frame.

Check before moving on. Both uprights sit flat on all three bars.

3.10 Wiring

StepClimber prototype: block-level wiring

Bought modules wired at block level; no circuit board is laid out. Stranded copper; ferrules on every screw terminal; crimped, keyed connectors at the pack and the motor.



Safety: pack unplugged until the stop points in section 6 of the plan are passed. Releasing the dead-man lever cuts the drive and the brake coil, so the brake applies.

Red: power. Blue: signal. Grey: brake coil. All circuits are extra-low voltage (29.2 V at most while charging). The brake is spring-applied: no power, brake on.

BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stepclimber

Figure 19. Block-level wiring with wire sizes. No circuit board is laid out at this stage; bought modules are wired together.

Wire it like this, with stranded copper, a ferrule on every screw terminal and keyed connectors at the pack and the motor:

1. Pack to the fuse box: the pack's keyed lead to the 40 A fuse, then the key switch, 2.5 mm² (14 AWG).
2. Fuse box to the motor driver supply input, 2.5 mm².
3. Motor driver output to the gearmotor's motor terminals, 2.5 mm², through the motor's keyed connector.
4. Driver brake output to the brake coil, 0.5 mm² (20 AWG). The brake is spring-applied: no power, brake on.
5. Driver supply to the 5 V converter (fused 2 A), 0.75 mm², and the converter to the controller, 0.5 mm².
6. Controller to the driver's speed and direction inputs, 0.25 mm² (24 AWG).
7. Controller to the handle pod (dead-man lever, up and down switch, light bar), a multicore lead of 0.25 mm² run up the right-hand upright and tied to the right-hand handle tube.

Check before moving on. With the pack out, every wire continues end to end, the supply leads read open to the frame, and every wire is labelled.

3.11 Bought components

Buy to specification, not brand. Line numbers are those of the bill of materials.

- **Hand truck frame (line 1).** Steel loop handle, 28 mm rails 400 mm apart, about 1,260 mm from toe plate to grip, 380 x 240 mm toe plate.

- **Wheels and hubs (line 2).** Six 200 mm solid rubber non-marking wheels, 45 mm hub length, two 20 mm bore sealed bearings each; two 1610 weld-on taper-lock hubs with 25 mm keyed bushes.
- **Drive (line 3).** 25 mm and 20 mm keyed shaft; two 25 mm and two 20 mm two-bolt flange bearings (bolt centres 99 and 90 mm); sprockets 20-tooth 08B bored 25 mm keyed, 10-tooth 08B and 35-tooth 06B bored 20 mm keyed (the 10-tooth hub no more than 27 mm across), 10-tooth 06B bored to the gearmotor shaft; 38 links of 08B chain and 54 links of 06B chain with connecting links.
- **Gearmotor (line 4).** 24 V brushed worm gearmotor, about 250 W, about 40 rpm and 30 N·m rated output, spring-applied brake, face-mounted gearbox about 95 x 90 x 95 mm, 20 mm keyed output shaft at least 25 mm long, motor at right angles to the output.
- **Electronics (lines 5, 6, 13).** 24 V 30 A brushed motor driver with current sensing and a brake output; microcontroller board with a 6-axis IMU, buzzer and light bar; IP54 box about 340 x 110 x 50 mm with standoffs and cable glands.
- **Pack (line 7).** 24 V LiFePO₄, 8S 10 Ah (256 Wh), with a BMS that has cell-level protection and blocks charging below 0 °C, in a quick-release cradle.
- **Fuse box and harness (line 8).** Key switch, 40 A fuse in a sealed holder, keyed connectors, 2.5 mm² wire.
- **Handle controls (line 9).** Clamp-on pod with a dead-man lever switch, an up and down thumb switch and a light bar.
- **Strap and skids (lines 10, 11).** 25 mm ratchet strap with hooks; UHMW strip 25 x 10 mm.
- **Charger (line 12).** 29.2 V 3 A LiFePO₄ charger.
- **Fixings (line 17).** Four M12 x 40 and four M10 x 35 bolts with nyloc nuts, two M10 countersunk screws with nuts (bearings); six M10 x 20 end screws, six 36 mm washers and six 4.5 mm spacers (wheels); three M8 screws (gearmotor); two M8 countersunk and two M8 button-head screws (spacers); six M6 x 70 bolts with nyloc nuts (uprights); four M5 countersunk screws (skids); sixteen M4 screws and rivets (band); medium threadlocker; cable ties.

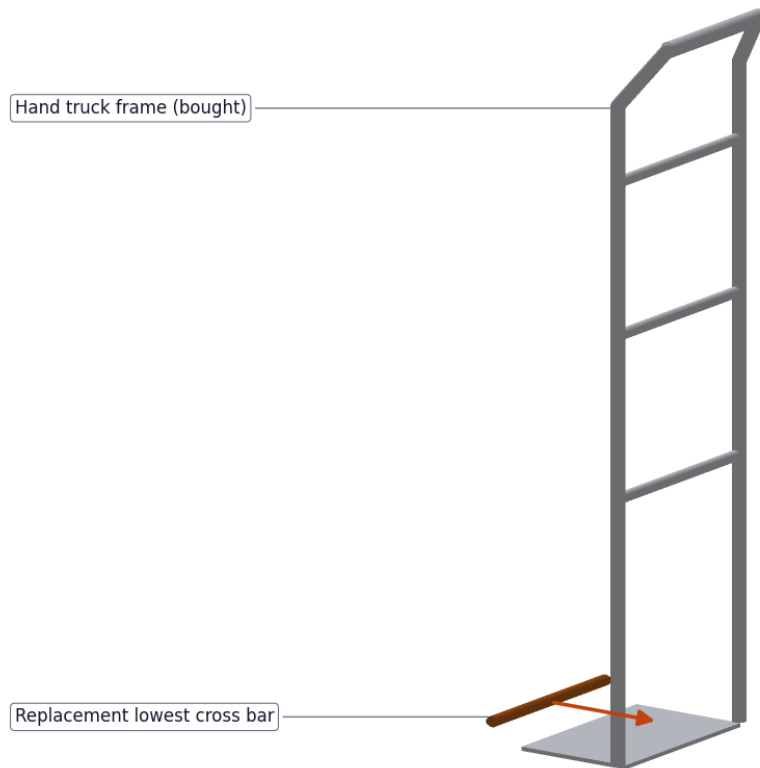
■ 4. Putting it together

In each picture the parts already fitted are grey and the parts being fitted are in colour, with an arrow showing the way they go in.

Step 1: replacement lowest cross bar

Step 1: replacement lowest cross bar

Wheels, axle and the bar 60 mm above the shaft line removed; new bar welded 105 mm below it



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

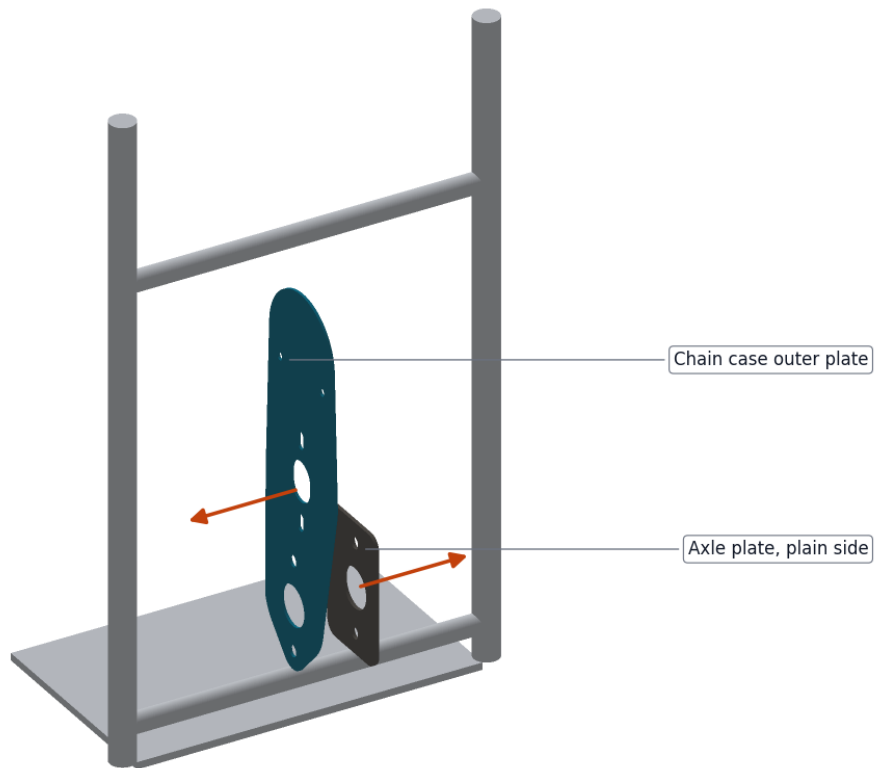
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Frame stripped and the bar 60 mm above the shaft line cut off (section 3.1). Weld the new bar between the rails 105 mm below the shaft line.

Step 2: axle plate and case outer plate onto the rails

Step 2: axle plate and case outer plate onto the rails

Welded to the inside of each rail on a 25 mm alignment bar through both bores



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

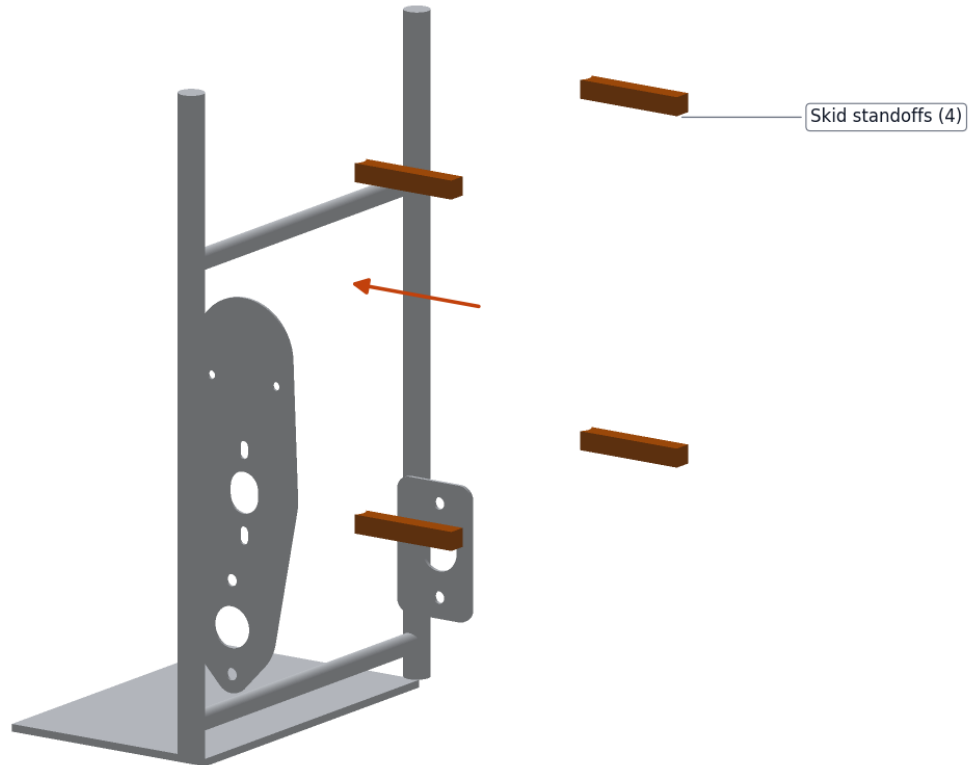
github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stepclimber

Clamp both plates to the insides of the rails with the alignment bar through both bores, the bar on the shaft line and 40 mm behind the rail centre lines, square to both rails. Tack each plate, check the bar still turns, then weld both sides of each plate along the rail. Let it cool and check again. **Hold point:** the bar turns freely in both bores.

Step 3: skid standoffs onto the rails

Step 3: skid standoffs onto the rails

Four standoffs, coped ends welded to the backs of the rails, 140 and 510 mm above the shaft line



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

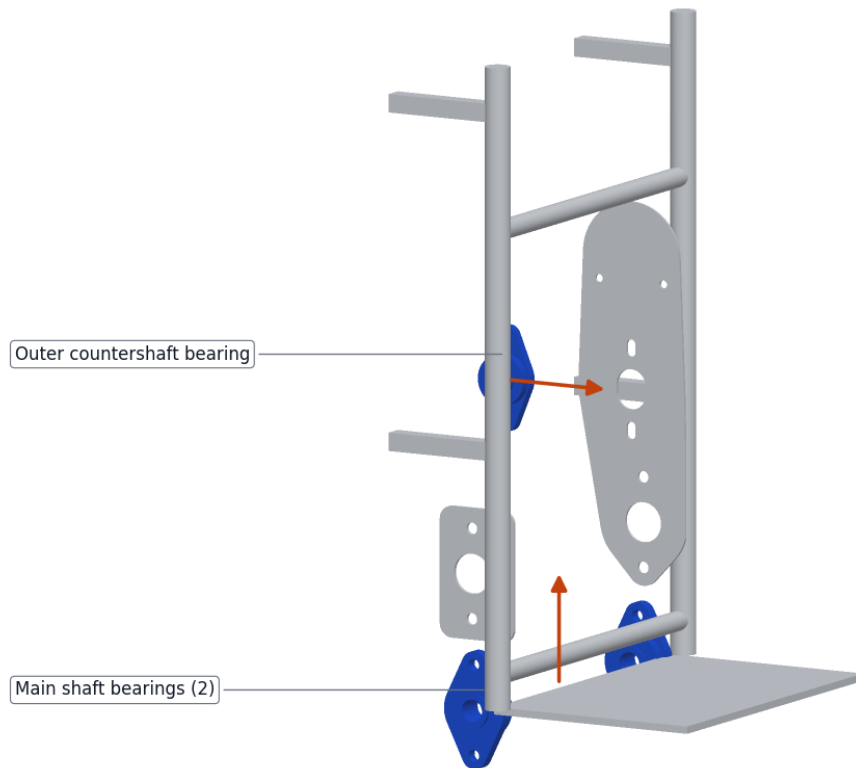
github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stepclimber

Weld the four standoffs to the backs of the rails, 140 and 510 mm above the shaft line, square to the rails and pointing straight back. Paint the frame where it is bare.

Step 4: main bearings and outer countershaft bearing

Step 4: main bearings and outer countershaft bearing

Bolted to the inside faces of the plates: M12 for the main bearings, M10 in the slots for the countershaft



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

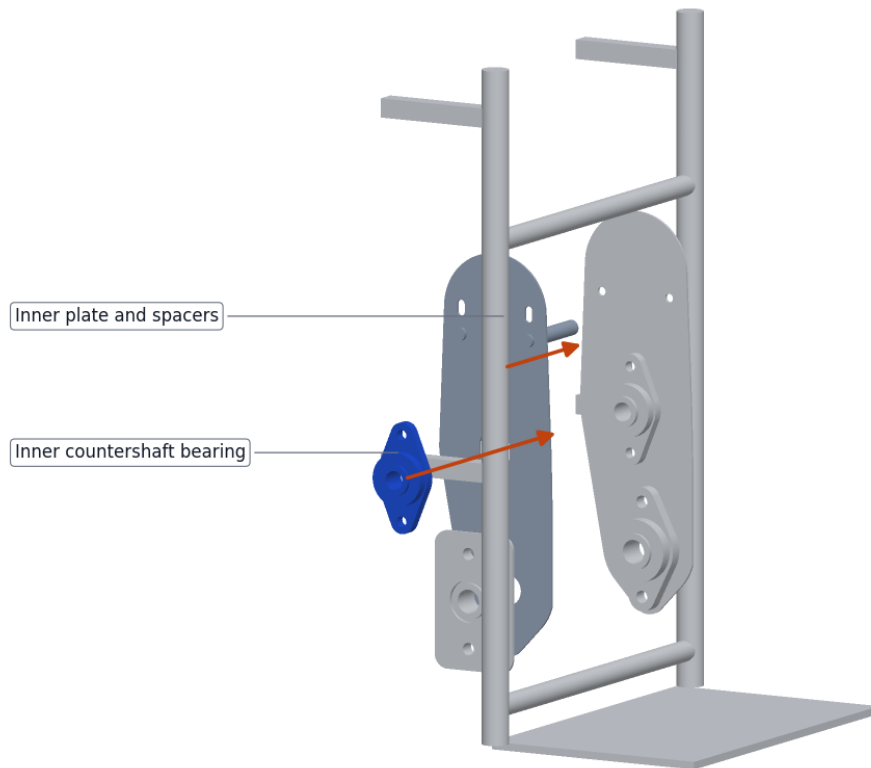
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Bolt a 25 mm flange bearing to the inside face of each axle plate with two M12 bolts, nuts outside, snug but not tight. Bolt the outer 20 mm bearing to the inside of the case outer plate with two M10 bolts through the slots, at the middle of the slots.

Step 5: case inner plate, spacers and inner countershaft bearing

Step 5: case inner plate, spacers and inner countershaft bearing

Two spacers on M8 screws; the inner bearing bolts to the gearbox side of the inner plate



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

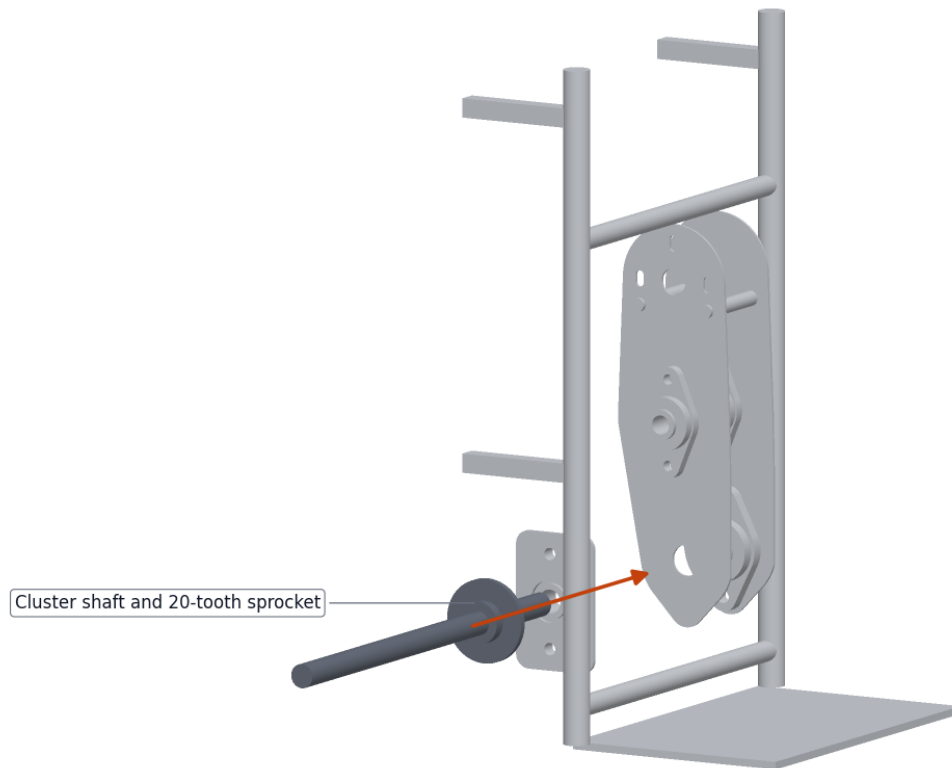
github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stepclimber

Screw the two spacers to the outer plate with M8 countersunk screws from outside. Bolt the inner 20 mm bearing to the gearbox side of the inner plate (countersunk M10 screws from the case side, nuts on the flange), at the middle of the slots. Put the inner plate on the spacers with two M8 button-head screws.

Step 6: cluster shaft and 20-tooth sprocket

Step 6: cluster shaft and 20-tooth sprocket

Slide the shaft in from the plain side; the sprocket goes on it inside the case before it reaches the drive side



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

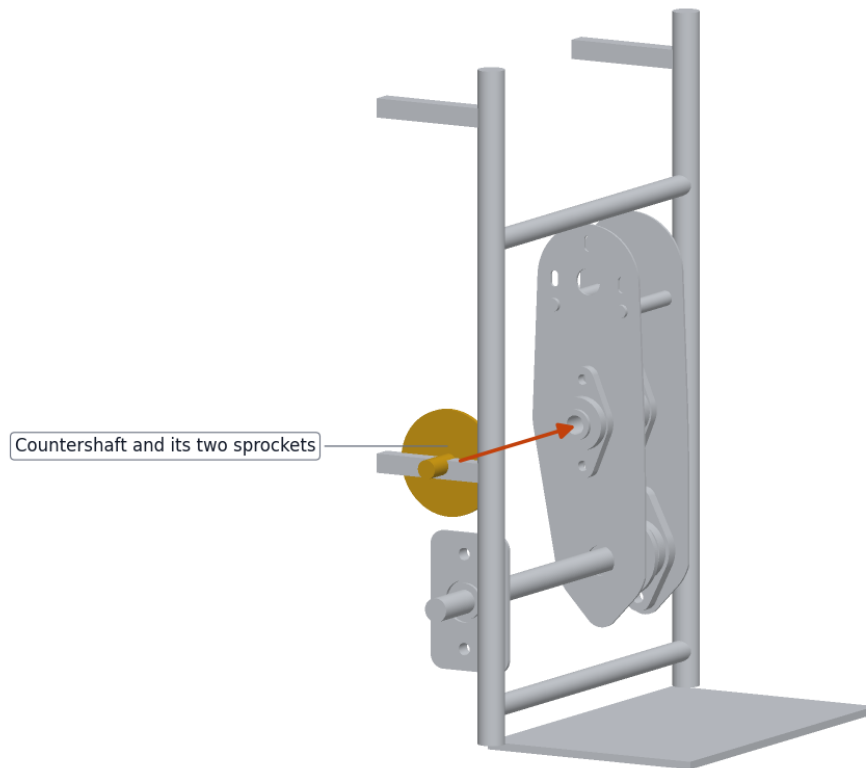
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From the left, slide the shaft through the left bearing and across the frame, through the inner plate's clearance hole, through the 20-tooth sprocket held inside the case, and into the right bearing. Centre the shaft so it stands 59 mm past each axle plate; fit the sprocket key. Tighten the four main bearing bolts.

Step 7: countershaft and its sprockets

Step 7: countershaft and its sprockets

Slide in from inside the truck through the inner bearing, the sprockets and into the outer bearing



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

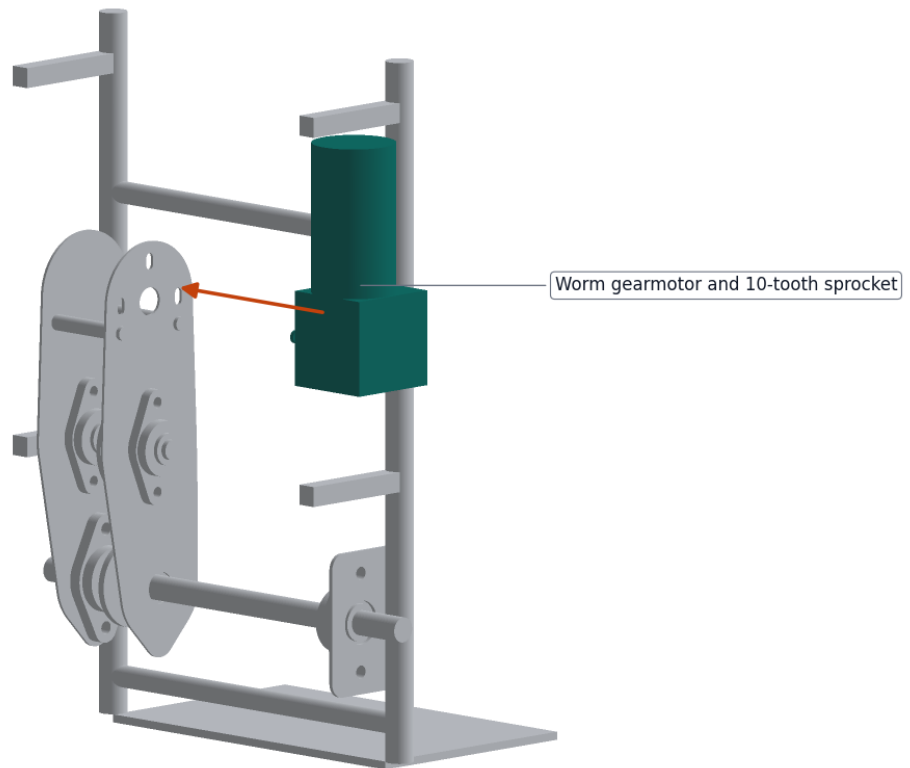
github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stepclimber

Hold the 35-tooth and 10-tooth sprockets inside the case, hub to hub, and slide the countershaft in from inside the truck through the inner bearing, both sprockets and into the outer bearing. Fit the keys; line the 10-tooth sprocket up with the 20-tooth sprocket on the cluster shaft using a straight edge.

Step 8: worm gearmotor

Step 8: worm gearmotor

Gearbox face on the inner plate, three M8 screws in the slots; sprocket on its output shaft inside the case



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

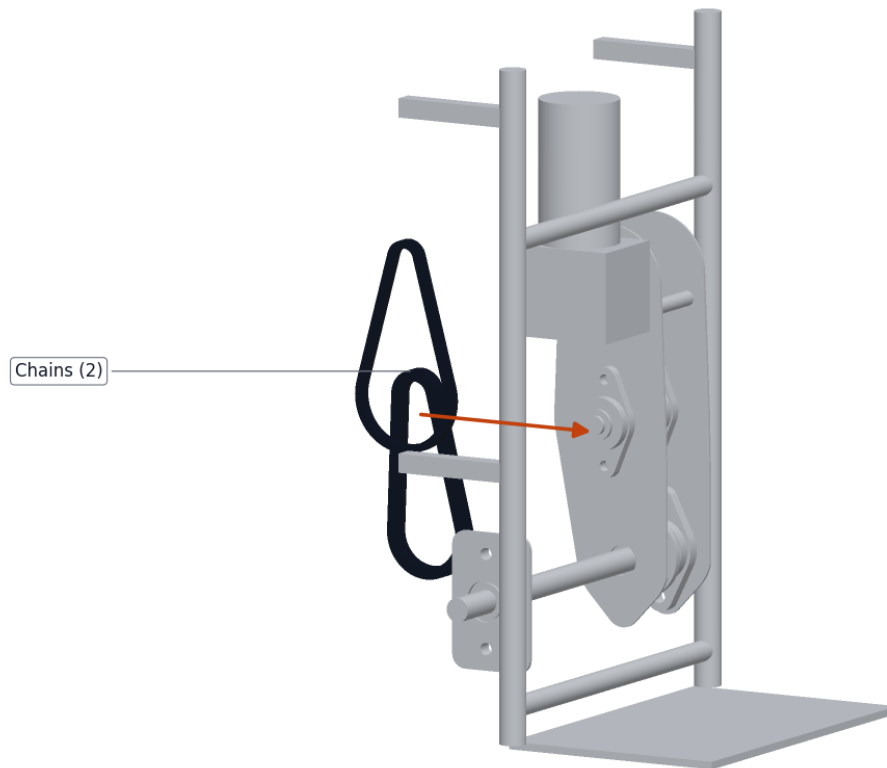
github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stepclimber

Fit the 10-tooth 06B sprocket on the gearmotor output, then put the output through the inner plate from the gearbox side and fit three M8 screws through the slots, at the middle of the slots, finger tight. Line the gearmotor sprocket up with the 35-tooth sprocket.

Step 9: chains on, then tension them

Step 9: chains on, then tension them

Final stage first by sliding the countershaft bearings, then the first stage by sliding the gearmotor



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

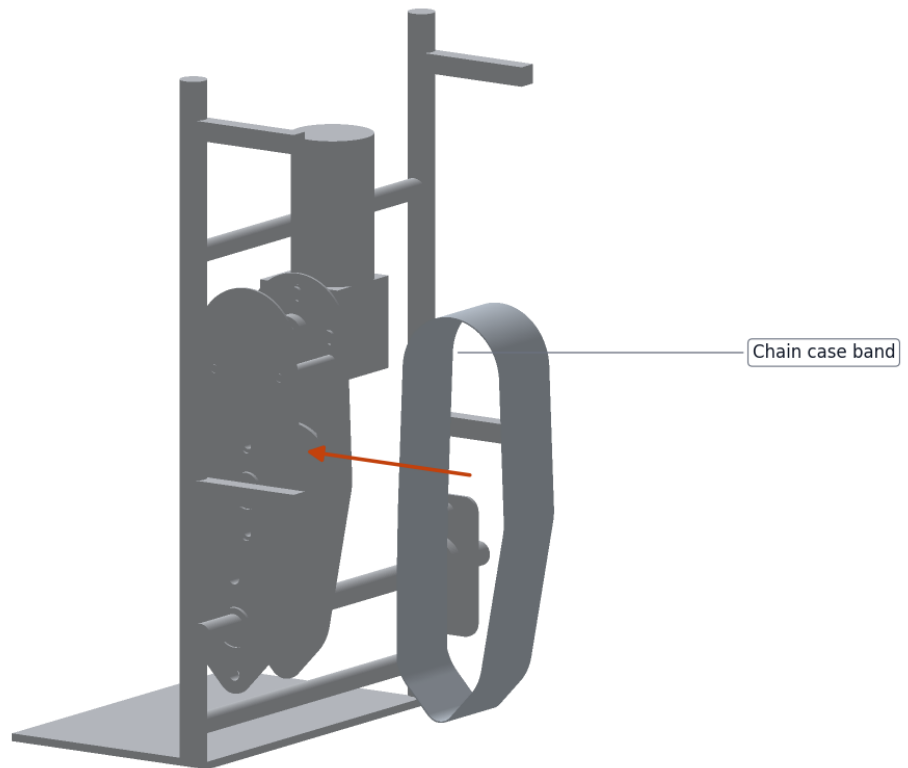
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Fit the 38-link 08B chain round the 20-tooth and 10-tooth sprockets and close it with its connecting link, clip closed end leading. Slide both countershaft bearings up their slots until the chain has about 4 mm of slack midway, then tighten their bolts. Fit the 54-link 06B chain the same way, slide the gearmotor up its slots to the same slack and tighten its three screws. Tighten every bearing grub screw. **Hold point:** both shafts turn by hand through a full turn with no tight spot, and the sprockets line up within 1 mm.

Step 10: close the chain case with the band

Step 10: close the chain case with the band

Band between the plates, flush with their edges, M4 screws through the tabs into both plates



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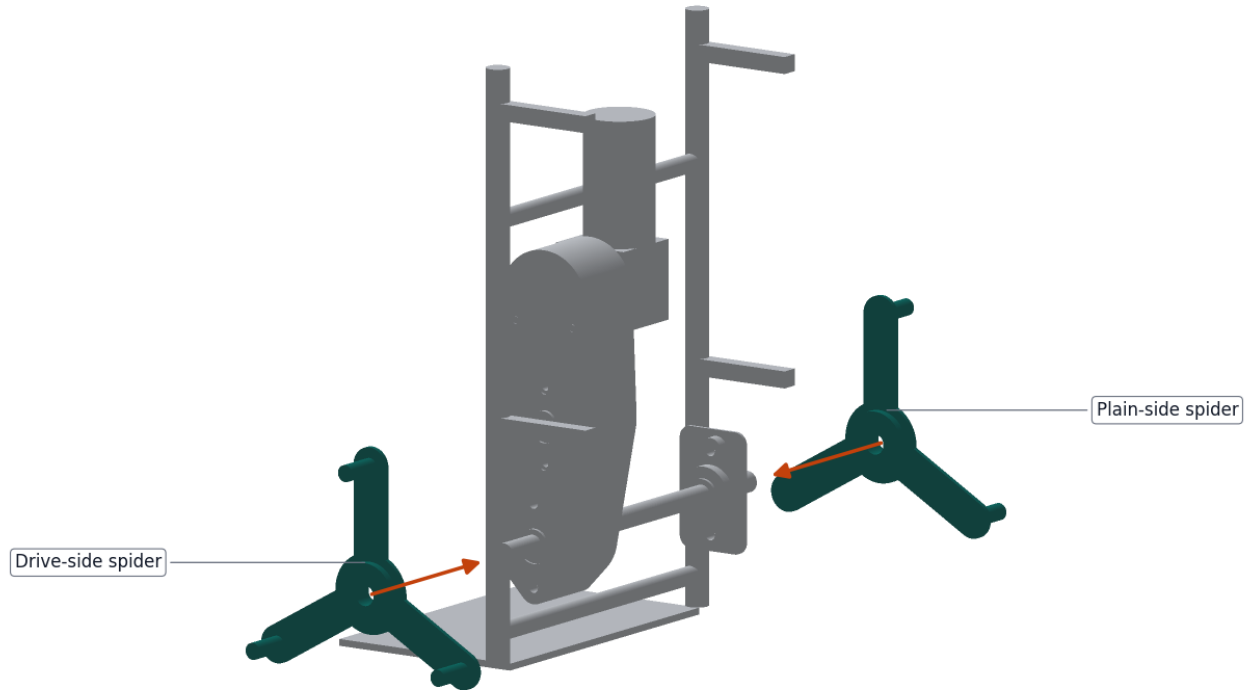
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Fit the band between the plates, flush with their edges, with M4 screws through its tabs into both plates.

Step 11: spiders onto the shaft ends

Step 11: spiders onto the shaft ends

Hub on the shaft end, key in, taper-lock bush tightened; outer face flush with the shaft end



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

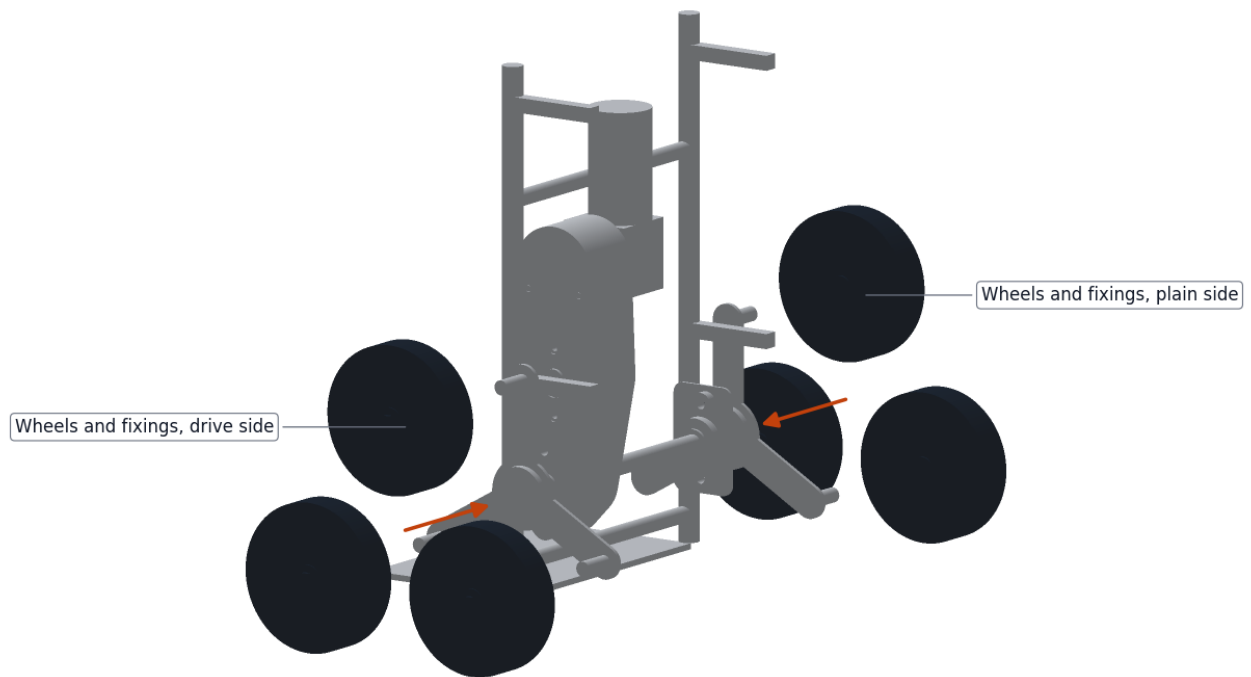
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Fit the key, slide each spider's hub onto the shaft end with the stub axles outward, set the hub's outer face flush with the shaft end and tighten the taper-lock bush to its maker's torque. Set both spiders at the same angle, one arm straight up.

Step 12: wheels onto the stub axles

Step 12: wheels onto the stub axles

Spacer, wheel, 36 mm washer and M10 end screw on each stub axle; the wheel must spin freely



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

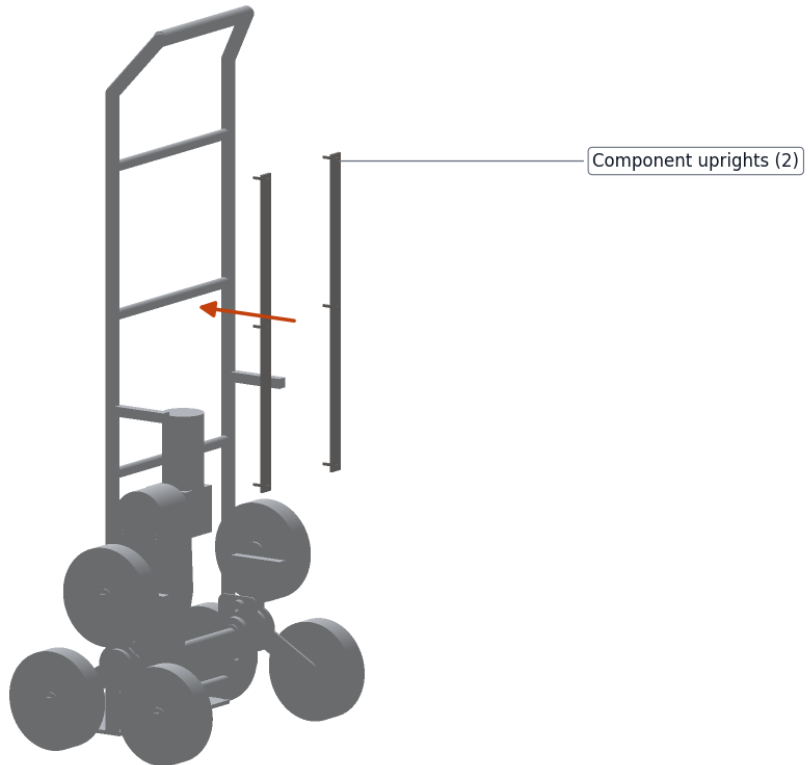
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On each stub axle: spacer, wheel, washer and an M10 end screw with medium threadlocker, tightened to about 25 N·m. Spin each wheel: it must turn freely.

Step 13: component uprights onto the cross bars

Step 13: component uprights onto the cross bars

Two uprights on the back of the three upper cross bars, M6 bolts through each bar



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

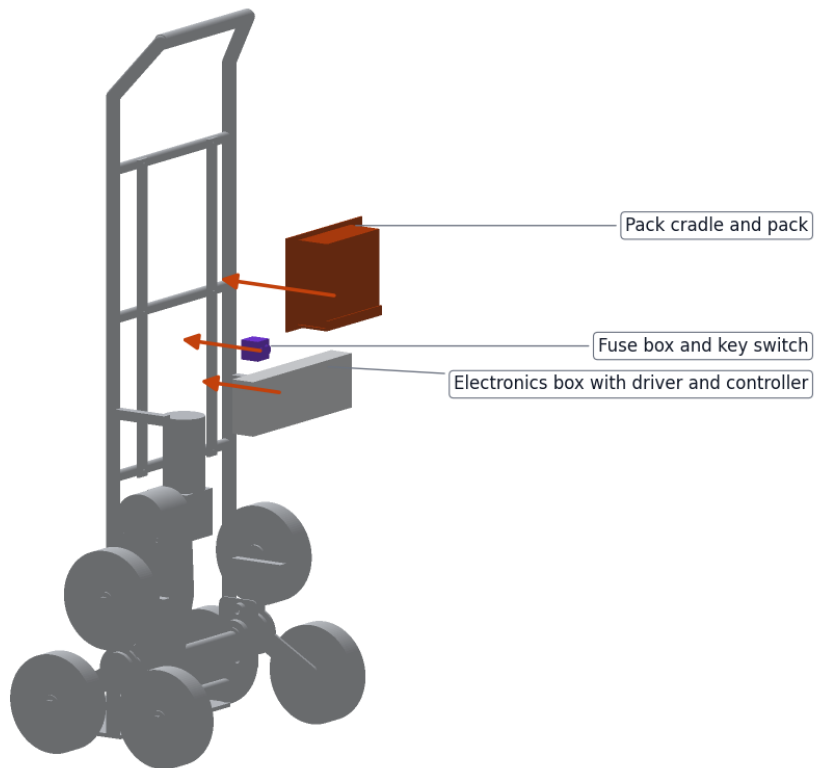
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Stand the truck upright. Clamp each upright to the backs of the three upper cross bars, 120 mm either side of the centre line, drill the bars through the upright holes and fit the M6 bolts with nyloc nuts on the load side.

Step 14: electronics box, fuse box and pack cradle

Step 14: electronics box, fuse box and pack cradle

Each bolted flat to both uprights (the fuse box to the drive-side upright); the pack stays out



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

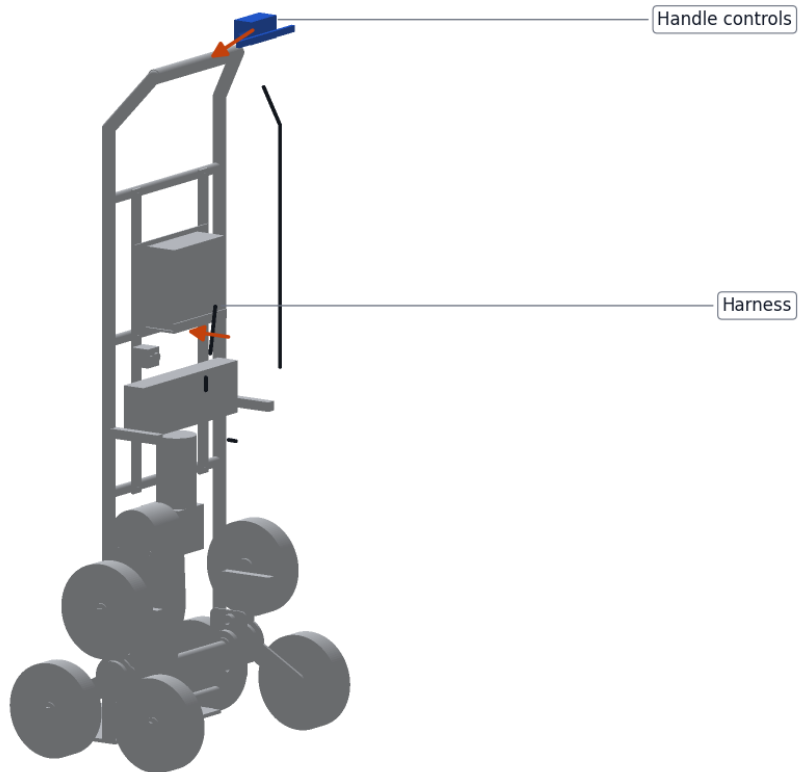
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Bolt the electronics box (with the driver and controller already fitted inside on their standoffs) flat to both uprights, its lid toward the back. Bolt the fuse box to the right-hand upright and the pack cradle to both. Leave the pack out.

Step 15: harness and handle controls

Step 15: harness and handle controls

Pod clamped round the grip; cables tied to the uprights and the drive-side handle tube



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

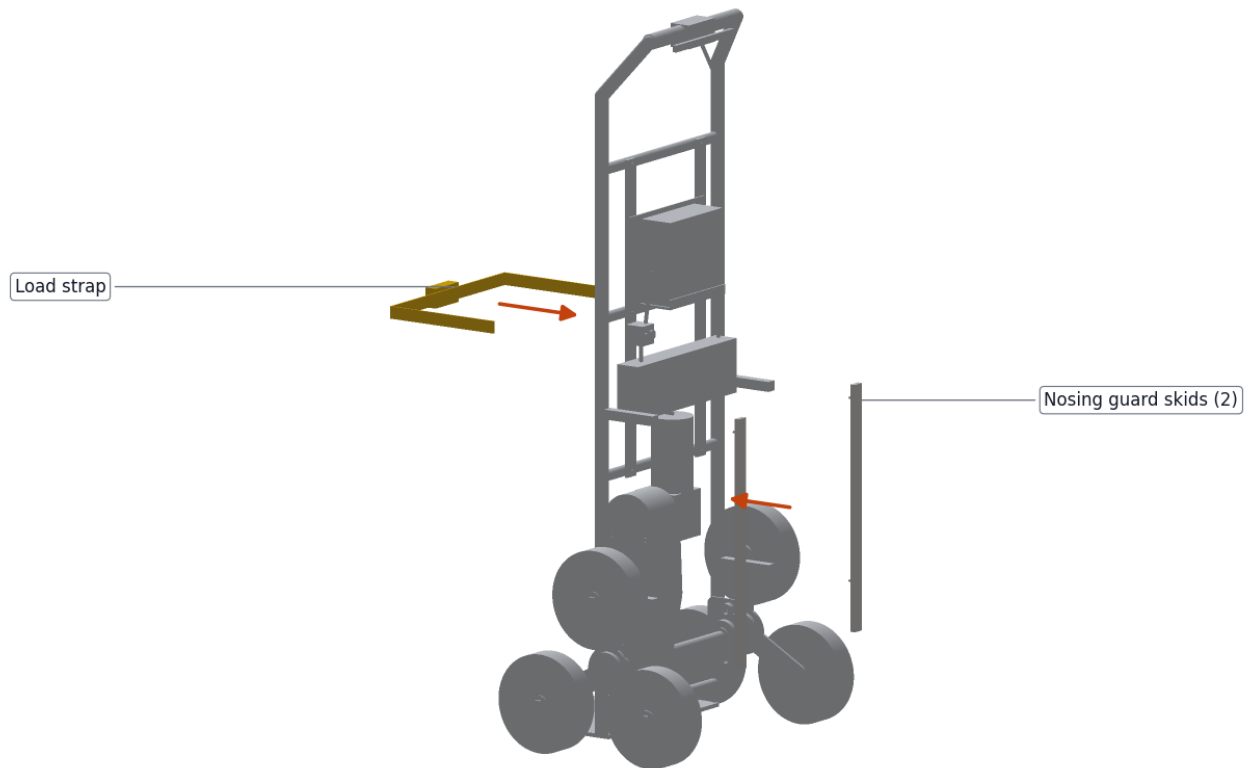
github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stepclimber

Clamp the control pod round the middle of the grip, lever behind. Run and tie the cables as in section 3.10: pack to fuse box, fuse box to electronics box, electronics box to motor, and the controls lead up the right-hand upright and handle tube to the pod. **Hold point:** the wiring checks of section 3.10 pass before going on.

Step 16: skids and load strap

Step 16: skids and load strap

Skids screwed to the standoff caps; strap hooks round the rails, ratchet on the load side



BUILD PLAN ILLUSTRATION, PLAN NOT YET BUILT

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Screw the skids to the standoff caps with M5 countersunk screws. Hook the strap round the rails about 650 mm above the shaft line, ratchet on the load side.

■ 5. First checks

These are the checks a TRL 4 test report would record; this plan only lists them. Requirement numbers are those of SCM-REQ-001.

Table 2. First checks.

Check	Requirement	How	Pass when
Clusters turn clear	R11, R15	Pack out, brake released by hand as the motor maker describes; turn each cluster through a full turn	Nothing touches the frame, standoffs or skids; 15 mm or more everywhere
Width and height	R11	Tape measure, truck upright	600 mm or less over the wheel end screws; 1,500 mm or less tall
Mass	R5	Weigh the truck with the pack	Recorded against the 34.2 kg estimate
Drive and brake, unloaded	R3, R8, R9	Wheels off the floor; pack in; hold the dead-man lever and press up, then down	Clusters turn both ways at 16 steps/min speed (one third of a turn in 3.75 s); releasing the lever stops them within 0.2 s and the brake holds
Hold with power off	R8	Wheels off the floor; pack out; a 140 N·m torque on a cluster by a lever and spring balance	The cluster does not turn
Tilt stop	R7	Truck on the flat, wheels chocked, drive running; tilt the frame past 3° from the set angle (the window for the first loaded trials) and past 15° and 45° from upright	The drive stops and the buzzer sounds each time
Push on the flat	R10	60 kg on the toe plate, strapped; spring balance on the grip	40 N or less at walking pace
Chain case clearance	R15	Gauge the case on the shaft line against a 54 mm radius template	The case is inside the template all round on the stair side
Charging	R13	Charger on the pack, on the charging spot	The BMS charges to 29.2 V and stops; the pack stays under 45 °C

■ 6. Safety stops

Stop at each point. Carry on only when everything listed is true.

- **S1. Before welding.** Paint and any zinc ground off the weld areas; a fire-safe area clear of the electronics, the pack and anything flammable; welding helmet, gloves and ventilation.
- **S2. Before the pack comes into the workshop.** Pack voltage about 24 to 27 V; no swelling, dents or damage; BMS datasheet from its maker. A charging spot on a non-combustible surface, away from sleeping areas, with a fire extinguisher for electrical fires within reach.
- **S3. Before the pack is first plugged in.** With the pack out, every supply lead reads open to the frame; the 40 A fuse is in its holder; the key switch is off; the wheels are off the floor (truck on a stand or blocks).
- **S4. Before the drive first turns.** Chain case closed; hands, sleeves and cables clear of the clusters; the dead-man lever stops the drive within 0.2 s and the brake applies with the power off.
- **S5. Before any load goes on the toe plate.** The power-off hold check of section 5 passes; the strap is fitted; every bearing bolt, hub bush and wheel end screw is tight.
- **S6. Before any use on a stair (outside this plan).** All first checks pass, with the results recorded in a TRL 4 test plan. Nobody stands below the truck on a stair.

■ 7. Tools, skills and workspace

Tools. MIG welder for 1.5 to 6 mm steel; angle grinder with cutting and flap discs; hacksaw or bandsaw; bench drill or a drill in a stand; drills 4 to 13 mm and a 32 mm step drill or hole saw; countersink; M5, M8 and M10 taps and tap drills; tube coping by file (14 mm half-round) or a hole saw notcher; flat and half-round files; deburring tool; scribe, engineer's square, steel rule, calipers and tape measure; 50 mm round bar and a vice for bending the band; hand rivet tool; clamps and the 25 mm alignment bar; spanners and sockets 8 to 19 mm; hex keys; torque wrench covering 10 to 60 N·m; chain breaker; straight edge; spring balance to 200 N; scale to 50 kg; multimeter; ferrule crimper and wire strippers; soldering iron.

Skills. Basic metalwork (marking out, cutting, drilling, tapping, coping tube, bending thin sheet) and MIG welding of light steel, by a competent welder; fitting bearings, sprockets and roller chain; crimping and screw-terminal wiring. All circuits are extra-low voltage (29.2 V at most, while charging); no mains wiring is part of the build, and the charger is a certified, undamaged unit.

Workspace. A floor area about 2 x 2 m with a bench; a welding area apart from the electronics and the pack; a stand or blocks that hold the truck upright with its wheels clear of the floor; the charging spot of S2.

Personal protective equipment. Welding helmet, welding gloves and flame-resistant clothing for welding; safety glasses for cutting, grinding and drilling; hearing protection for grinding; cut-resistant gloves for sheet and bar; no gloves near a turning drill.

■ 8. Where the numbers come from

- Model and constructability checks: `cad/src/model.py` (`python cad/src/model.py --check` , 90 checks); STEP and STL exports in `cad/step/` and `cad/stl/` .
- Pictures: `cad/src/build_plan_media.py` , using `.kit/build_views.py` ; written to `docs/05-build-plan/` and `cad/drawings/SCM-DWG-101` to `SCM-DWG-109` .
- General arrangement: `cad/drawings/SCM-DWG-001.pdf` , Rev P5.
- Calculations: `docs/04-calcs/01-sizing.md` (SCM-CAL-001 v0.5) and `docs/04-calcs/sizing.py` : chain centres and pulls (section 4), nosing clearances of the frame-fixed outlines (section 3), structure (section 8), mass (section 9).
- Bill of materials: `bom/bom.csv` .
- Decisions: `docs/decisions/0003-design-for-construction.md` (SCM-DDR-003), with SCM-DDR-001 and SCM-DDR-002; the register `docs/06-design-decisions.md` (SCM-DEC-001).
- Requirements: `docs/03-requirements.md` (SCM-REQ-001 v0.5).